פְּרִי צַדִּיק

Pri Tzaddik

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Sefer Shemos · Volume I

Shemos – Yitro

Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin
(1823–1900)

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Pri Tzaddik

A Bilingual Interlinear Edition · Volume I · Shemos – Yitro

This volume presents Pri Tzaddik on Parshas Shemos, Vaera, Bo, Beshalach and Yitro in bilingual interlinear form. The vocalized Hebrew is followed phrase by phrase by its English translation, with source quotations and annotated parallel teachings in numbered footnotes.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, source organization, and formatting. The original Hebrew remains the controlling text for study. Editorial headings and explanations are aids to understanding and are distinct from Rav Tzadok's original words.

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פָּרָשַׁת שְׁמוֹת
כְּתַב יַד קֹדֶשׁ — Shemos — Manuscript

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁמוֹת מַתְחִיל בִּשְׁמוֹת הַשְּׁבָטִים, **Parashat Shemot begins with the names of the tribes,** דְּסֵפֶר זֶה הוּא דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה, **for this book is the book of the Giving of the Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה (ג, ה׳) עַל פָּסוּק "וַיְהִי אוֹר" – זֶה סֵפֶר שְׁמוֹת, **as stated in Bereishit Rabbah 3:5 on the verse "And there was light" – this refers to the Book of Shemot,** שֶׁהוּא הֲוָיַת הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה.[1] **which is the actualization and being of the light of Torah.** וְיָדוּעַ דִּשְׁשִׁים רִבּוֹא אוֹתִיּוֹת בַּתּוֹרָה נֶגֶד שִׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא נַפְשׁוֹת דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, **And it is known that there are 600,000 letters in the Torah corresponding to the 600,000 souls of Israel,** כִּי אוֹר הַתּוֹרָה הוּא עַצְמוֹ אוֹר הַנְּפָשׁוֹת דִּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. **for the light of the Torah is itself the light of the souls of the Children of Israel.** וּמַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ שִׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא, **And regarding that which they said 600,000,** אַף שֶׁאֵין שִׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא אוֹתִיּוֹת בַּתּוֹרָה כַּיָּדוּעַ, **even though there are not literally 600,000 letters in the Torah as is known,** רַק שֶׁכָּל אוֹת מְחוּבָּר מֵאוֹתִיּוֹת, **it is rather because every letter is composed of sub-letters,** כְּמוֹ לָמֶ"ד מֵ"ם הֵם כַּ"ף וָא"ו, **such as lamed and mem, which are formed from a kaf and a vav,** צָדֵ"י הוּא נוּ"ן וָא"ו, **tzadi is a nun and a vav,** שִׁי"ן ג' וָוִי"ן, **shin is three vavs,** אָל"ף ב' יוּדִי"ן וּבָאֶמְצַע וָא"ו, וְכַדּוֹמֶה. **alef is two yods with a vav in the center, and so forth.** וְהַגַּם דְּגַם בָּזֶה אֵין הַחֶשְׁבּוֹן מְכֻוָּן שִׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא, **And even though in this calculation as well the sum does not precisely hit 600,000,** אֲבָל תָּפְסוּ הַמִּסְפָּר שִׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא שֶׁהָיוּ בְּדוֹר הַמִּדְבָּר מְקַבְּלֵי הַתּוֹרָה. **nonetheless they adopted the figure of 600,000 who were in the generation of the wilderness, the receivers of the Torah.** וְגַם נַפְשׁוֹת כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת שָׁרְשָׁם מֵהַתּוֹרָה וּמֵאוֹתָם אוֹתִיּוֹת, **Moreover, the souls of all subsequent generations have their root in the Torah and in those very letters,** כִּי הַרְבֵּה נְפָשׁוֹת בְּאוֹת אֶחָד, **for many souls root within a single letter,** וּכְלַל כָּל הַנְּפָשׁוֹת מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל הֵם כְּלוּלִים בִּשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים, **and the totality of all souls from Israel are subsumed within the twelve tribes,** וְעַל כֵּן שְׁמוֹת הַשְּׁבָטִים, שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹתָם – דְּהַשֵּׁם הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַחַיּוּת – הוּא גַּם כֵּן כּוֹלֵל כָּל הַתּוֹרָה.[2] **and therefore the names of the tribes, which constitute the root of their souls—since the name is the root of vitality—likewise encompasses the entire Torah.**

וּבְכָל פַּעַם שֶׁנִּזְכָּר שְׁמוֹת הַשְּׁבָטִים בַּתּוֹרָה **And every time that the names of the tribes are mentioned in the Torah,** הוּא בְּכַוָּנָה מְיוּחֶדֶת בְּהוֹרָאַת שְׁמוֹתָם עַל אוֹתוֹ הָעִנְיָן שָׁמְּדַבֵּר שָׁם, **it is with a specific intention based on the signification of their names regarding the matter discussed there,** כִּי כָּל הַקְּדוּשׁוֹת כְּלוּלוֹת בָּהֶם וְהַשֵּׁמוֹת מְרַמְּזִים עַל זֶה. **for all spiritual sanctities are included within them and the names allude to this.** וּבְרֵישׁ שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה (א׳, ה׳) דְּנָקְרָאִים עַל שֵׁם הַגְּאוּלָה, עַיֵּן שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת.[3] **And at the start of Shemot Rabbah, 1:5, it states that they are**

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[1] **Bereshit Rabbah 3:5**: “Rabbi Simon said: Light is mentioned here five times, corresponding to the five books of the Torah. ‘God said, Let there be light’ corresponds to Genesis, with which the Holy One, blessed be He, occupied Himself in creating His world. ‘And there was light’ corresponds to Exodus, in which Israel emerged from darkness into light. ‘God saw that the light was good’ corresponds to Leviticus, which is filled with many laws. ‘God separated the light from the darkness’ corresponds to Numbers, which distinguishes those who left Egypt from those who entered the Land. ‘God called the light day’ corresponds to Deuteronomy, which is filled with many laws. The companions objected to Rabbi Simon: ‘But Leviticus is already filled with many laws!’ He replied: ‘Deuteronomy repeats a matter as well.’”

[2] Parallel: **Pri Tzaddik, Vayishlach 10:1**: ““Whole in his Torah” corresponds to “with all your soul.” For “A person’s soul is Hashem’s lamp,” and “Your word is a lamp for my feet and a light for my path”—the light of Torah. All Israel’s souls together constitute the words of Torah, as the sacred books explain the name Israel: “There are six hundred thousand letters in the Torah.” Each Jewish soul is a letter, or part of a letter, among the Torah’s letters; that letter illuminates and directs the Jewish soul’s path. Thus, “What are the righteous like before the Divine Presence? A lamp before a great flame.” “Whole in his Torah” therefore means that all Israel’s souls are within holiness.”
Connection: Vayishlach adds the individual consequence of this collective correspondence: each soul’s particular letter in Torah illuminates and directs its own path.

[3] **Shemot Rabbah 1:5**: ““These are the names of the children of Israel”—they are mentioned here in connection with Israel’s redemption. Reuben: “I have surely seen My people’s affliction.” Simeon: “God heard their groaning.” Levi: because the Holy One, blessed be He, joined in their distress, “from within the bush,” fulfilling, “I am with him in distress.” Judah: because they gave thanks to the Holy One, blessed be He. Issachar: the Holy One, blessed be He, rewarded their bondage with the spoil of Egypt and the sea, fulfilling, “Afterward they shall leave with great wealth.” Zebulun: because the Holy One, blessed be He, caused His Presence to dwell among them, as it says, “They shall make Me a sanctuary, and I shall dwell among them.” Zebulun signifies the Temple, as it says, “I have built You a lofty house, a place for You to dwell forever.” Benjamin: “Your right hand, Lord, is majestic in strength.” Dan: “The nation that enslaves them I shall judge, and afterward they shall leave with great wealth.” Naphtali: the Torah and commandments the Holy One, blessed be He, gave them, of which it is written, “Sweeter than honey and dripping

designated after the redemption, see there at length, וּרְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר דְּזִכְרוֹן שְׁמוֹתָם סִימָן הוּא עַל שֵׁם הַגְּאוּלָּה הָרְמוּזָה גַּם כֵּן בִּשְׁמוֹתָם, **and it means to say that the mention of their names serves as an omen reflecting the redemption that is likewise hinted at in their names,** כִּי עַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁת נַפְשׁוֹתָם הָיְתָה הַגְּאוּלָּה, **for through the holiness of their souls the redemption was brought about,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: רָאוֹ רָאִיתִי אֶת עֳנִי עַמִּי", שִׁמְעוֹן – "רָאָה וְכוּלֵי. **as it is written: Reuven corresponds to "I have surely seen (ra'oh ra'iti) the affliction of My people," Shimon, etc.** כִּי בְּשֶׁבֶט רְאוּבֵן הָיְתָה קְדוּשַׁת הָרְאִיָּה, **For in the tribe of Reuven resided the sanctity of vision,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה גַּם כֵּן רָאָה ה', **and through this Hashem likewise "saw",** וְכֵן בְּשִׁמְעוֹן קְדוּשַׁת הַשְּׁמִיעָה, **and similarly in Shimon resided the sanctity of hearing,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה גַּם כֵּן שָׁמַע ה' אֶת נַאֲקָתָם, **and through this Hashem likewise heard their groaning,** וְכֵן בְּכוּלָּם כְּפִי הַקְּדוּשָׁה שֶׁלָּהֶם הַמְּרוּמָז בִּשְׁמָם **and so with all of them, according to their sanctity hinted at in their name,** נִתְעוֹרֵר עַל יְדֵי זֶה לְמַעְלָה גַּם כֵּן כְּטַעַם "ה' צִלְּךָ", **there was awakened above a corresponding response in the spirit of "Hashem is your shadow",** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה בָּא הַגְּאוּלָּה.[4] **and through this the redemption came.**

And even though they are recorded at the onset of the exile, אֲבָל עִיקַּר הַגָּלוּת וְגַם דְּהֵם נִזְכָּרִים בְּהַתְחָלַת הַגָּלוּת, **nevertheless the essential purpose of the exile was for the sake of the redemption,** וּכְמוֹ בִּשְׁבִיל הַגְּאוּלָּה, **and as it is written in the Midrash there, "for whom Hashem loves He rebukes",** שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ שָׁם דְּ"אֲשֶׁר יֶאֱהַב ה' יוֹכִיחַ". **and the entire exile was solely in order to attain the redemption and the reception of the Torah.** וְכָל הַגָּלוּת הָיָה רַק כְּדֵי לָבוֹא לַגְּאוּלָּה וּלְקַבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה. **And regarding this it mentions the names of the tribes there from the perspective of their allusion to the redemption which is the intended aim of the exile,** וְעַל זֶה הוּא מַזְכִּיר שָׁם שְׁמוֹת הַשְּׁבָטִים מִצַּד רְמִיזָתָם עַל הַגְּאוּלָּה שֶׁהוּא מְכֻוָּן הַגָּלוּת, [5]**and all is a preparation for the Giving of the Torah,** וְהַכֹּל הֶכָנָה לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה, **as written there and in Berakhot (5a) that three gifts are given through tribulations,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּבְרָכוֹת (ה עמוד א) דְּג' מַתָּנוֹת עַל יְדֵי יִסּוּרִין,[6] **as it is written, "and reproofs of instruction are the way of life."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב "וְדֶרֶךְ חַיִּים תּוֹכְחוֹת מוּסָר".

And these four parashiyot Sh-V-B-V (Shemot, Va'era, Bo, Beshalach) are the preparation for the Giving of the Torah found in Parashat Yitro, וְאַרְבַּע פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת אֵלּוּ שׁוֹבָ"ב – הֵכָנָה לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּפָרָשַׁת יִתְרוֹ **and afterward Parashat Mishpatim is to deliver man from the judges of his soul,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ מִשְׁפָּטִים – לְהוֹשִׁיעַ מִשּׁוֹפְטֵי נַפְשׁוֹ, **who are those whose evil inclination likewise judges them as described in chapter HaRoeh,** שֶׁהֵם אוֹתָם אֲשֶׁר גַּם יֵצֶר הָרָע שׁוֹפְטָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּהָרוֹאֶה **and to execute the recorded**

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honeycomb." Gad: the manna the Holy One, blessed be He, fed them, which was "like coriander seed." Asher: all who heard of their redemption and greatness acclaimed them, as it is written, "All nations shall call you fortunate, for you shall be a land of delight, says the Lord of hosts." Joseph: because the Holy One, blessed be He, will again redeem Israel from the wicked kingdom, as He redeemed them from Egypt, as it is written, "On that day the Lord shall again extend His hand a second time…""

[4] Parallel: **Kometz HaMinchah 2:79:1**: "A name everywhere expresses a thing's power, existence, and vitality, as Scripture says, "Whatever the man called each living creature, that was its name." Therefore the Sages say that, among the tribes, wherever "therefore" introduces the naming, the tribe had a numerous population: the name is its vitality, and the reason for the name is the source of that vitality. "Therefore" means that the name remains attached to its reason; when vitality remains attached to its source, it flows abundantly."

Connection: Kometz HaMinchah explains why the reason behind a tribal name matters: attachment of the name to its source produces an abundant flow of life.

[5] **Berakhot 5a**: "A baraita teaches: Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai says that the Holy One, blessed be He, gave Israel three good gifts, all of them through suffering: Torah, the Land of Israel, and the World to Come. What is the source for Torah? "Happy is the man whom You discipline, God, and teach from Your Torah." For the Land of Israel: "As a man disciplines his son, Hashem your God disciplines you," followed by, "For Hashem your God brings you to a good land." For the World to Come: "The commandment is a lamp and Torah is light; the way of life is the reproof of discipline.""

[6] **Berakhot 5a**: "Rabbi Yitzchak said: Whoever recites Shema upon his bed is as though he holds a two-edged sword, as it says, "God's exalted praises are in their throats, and a two-edged sword in their hands." How does the verse indicate this? Mar Zutra—or, according to another report, Rav Ashi—said: From the beginning of the passage, "Let the devoted rejoice in honor; let them sing upon their beds," followed by, "God's exalted praises are in their throats, and a two-edged sword in their hands." Rabbi Yitzchak also said: Whoever recites Shema upon his bed keeps destructive forces away, as it says, "The sons of reshef fly high." "Flight" refers to Torah, as in, "Will you let your eyes fly toward it, and it is gone?" "Reshef" refers to destructive forces, as in, "Exhausted by hunger and devoured by reshef and bitter destruction.""

judgment upon his own spiritual adversaries, שֶׁהֵם עַצְמָם חֵיילוֹת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁעוֹלֶה וּמְקַטְרֵג. **which are themselves the legions of the evil inclination that ascend and accuse.** וְזֶהוּ פָּרָשִׁיוֹת הַשּׁוֹבָבִי"ם, **And this is the season of the parashiyot of Shovavim,** שֶׁהוּא זְמַן תְּשׁוּבָה לְבָנִים שׁוֹבָבִים בְּתִיקּוּן הַבְּרִית, **which is an auspicious time of repentance for "wayward children" in rectifying the Covenant,** בְּדָבָר שֶׁאֵין הַתְּשׁוּבָה מוֹעֶלֶת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר, **in an offense where ordinary repentance does not fully avail as written in the Zohar.** אֲבָל יֵשׁ לוֹ תִּיקּוּן עַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **However, it does have a rectification through the words of Torah,** שֶׁהוּא מַחֲכְמָה, לְמַעְלָה מִתְּשׁוּבָה שֶׁהוּא מִבִּינָה, **which stem from Chokhmah (Wisdom), transcending repentance which stems from Binah (Understanding),** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב "וּלְבָבוֹ יָבִין וְשָׁב". **as it is written, "and his heart shall understand, and he shall return and be healed."**

וְהוּא רָמוּז בִּבְרָכוֹת (ה עַמּוּד א) דִּבְקְרִיאַת שְׁמַע שֶׁעַל מִטָּתוֹ **And this is alluded to in Berakhot (5a) regarding the Bedtime Shema,** אוֹתוֹ חֶרֶב פִּיפִיּוֹת לַהֲרוֹג הַמַּזִּיקִין,[7] **which serves as that double-edged sword to destroy demonic damaging spirits,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ כֹּחַ הָאוּמּוֹת "לֶאְסֹר מַלְכֵיהֶם... וְנִכְבְּדֵיהֶם". וְזֶהוּ. **and this is "to bind their kings... and their nobles," which represents the primal root of the nations' strength.** וּפִיפִיּוֹת – דְּרָצָה לוֹמַר "שְׁנֵי פִיּוֹת, הַקּוֹל קוֹל יַעֲקֹב", **And "pipiyot" (double-edged) means two mouths, corresponding to "The voice is the voice of Jacob",** דְּאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: קוֹל תּוֹרָה וְקוֹל תְּפִלָּה, **of which our Sages of blessed memory expounded: the voice of Torah and the voice of prayer,** דְּקְרִיאַת שְׁמַע כּוֹלֵל שְׁנֵיהֶם, **for the Shema encompasses both,** דְּעִיקָּרָהּ תּוֹרָה, **since in its essence it is Torah study,** וּבְקְרִיאַת שְׁמַע שַׁחֲרִית וְעַרְבִית קְיֵים "לֹא יָמוּשׁ", **and through reciting the Shema morning and evening one fulfills "it shall not depart",** וְשֶׁלֹּא בִּזְמַנָּהּ כְּעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה, **and recited outside its designated halakhic window it is valued as engaging in Torah,** וּבְעוֹנָתָהּ עָדִיף, שֶׁהִיא גַּם בְּכְלַל תְּפִלָּה, **yet within its appointed time it is superior, being additionally categorized as prayer,** דְּהִיא בִּכְלַל צְלוֹתָא (יא עַמּוּד א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתְבוּ תּוֹסָפוֹת בְּשַׁבָּת.[8] **as Tosafot wrote in Shabbat (11a) that it is included in prayer.** וּקְרָא חֲשִׁיב שִׁשָּׁה דְּבָרִים:[9] **And Scripture in Psalm 149 enumerates six things:** חֶרֶב פִּיפִיּוֹת, **a two-edged sword,** לַעֲשׂוֹת נְקָמָה, **to execute vengeance,** תּוֹכָחוֹת בַּלְאֻמִּים, **punishments upon the peoples,** לֶאְסֹר מַלְכֵיהֶם, **to bind their kings,** וְנִכְבְּדֵיהֶם, **and their nobles,** לַעֲשׂוֹת מִשְׁפָּט, **to execute judgment,** וְהֵם שֵׁשׁ פָּרָשִׁיוֹת אֵלּוּ **and these correspond to these six parashiyot (Shovavim),** שֶׁהֵם נֶגֶד שֵׁשׁ סְפִירוֹת מֵחֶסֶד עַד יְסוֹד, **which face the six sefirot from Chesed down through Yesod,** בְּחֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת יְכֻפַּר עָוֹן". **and "by lovingkindness and truth iniquity is expiated."**

וּשְׁמוֹת, שֶׁהוּא סִיפּוּר הַגָּלוּת, הוּא מִצַּד הַחֶסֶד, **And Parashat Shemot, which recounts the narrative of the exile, emerges from the side of Chesed,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵישׁ שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה עַל זֶה קְרָא דִּ"אוֹתָהּ שִׁחֲרוּ מוּסָר" וַ"אֲשֶׁר יֶאֱהַב ה' יוֹכִיחַ", **as written at the opening of Shemot Rabbah regarding the verses "he who loves him disciplines him early" and "whom Hashem loves He rebukes",** שֶׁהוּא מִצַּד הָאַהֲבָה וְהַחֶסֶד. **which shows it is directed from love and kindness.** וְאַבְרָהָם בֵּירַר לוֹ הַמַּלְכֻיּוֹת, **And Abraham chose the exile of the empires,** וְהוּגַד לוֹ גָּלוּת מִצְרַיִם בְּשֶׁנִּשְׁאַל "בַּמֶּה אֵדַע כִּי אִירָשֶׁנָּה", **and the exile of Egypt was foretold to him when he asked, "Whereby shall I know that I shall inherit it?",** דִּירוּשַׁת הָאָרֶץ הוּא לַצַּדִּיקִים, **for the inheritance of the Holy Land is preserved for the righteous,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים, לְעוֹלָם יִירְשׁוּ אָרֶץ", **as it is written: "And your people are all righteous, they shall inherit the land forever",** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר "בַּמֶּה אֵדַע", **and over this he said "Whereby shall I know",** כִּי יָדַע שֶׁגַּם בְּזַרְעוֹ יִמָּצֵא פּוֹגְמֵי הַבְּרִית, **because he foresaw that within his offspring there would**

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[7] **Tosafot on Shabbat 11a**: ""Such as Rabbi Shimon ben Yohai and his companions." But below, on 33b, it says that when the time for prayer arrived, he would dress, wrap himself, and pray. That reference to praying means the recitation of Shema."

[8] **Psalms 149:6-9**: "The exaltation of God is in their throats, and a double-edged sword in their hand: to carry out vengeance among the nations and rebuke among the peoples; to bind their kings with chains and their dignitaries with iron fetters; to execute upon them the written judgment. This is the splendor of all His devoted ones. Hallelujah!" Context: The six expressions enumerated in the text occur in verses 6–9.

[9] **Nedarim 31b**: "If one vows, "Benefit from the uncircumcised is forbidden to me," he may benefit from uncircumcised Israelites but may not benefit from circumcised members of the nations. If he vows against benefit from the circumcised, he may not benefit from uncircumcised Israelites, but may benefit from circumcised members of the nations. For the designation "uncircumcised" is applied to the nations, as it says, "All the nations are uncircumcised, and all the house of Israel are uncircumcised in heart." It also says, "This uncircumcised Philistine," and, "Lest the daughters of the Philistines rejoice, lest the daughters of the uncircumcised exult.""

also be found those who blemish the Covenant, וְצַדִּיק נִקְרָא שׁוֹמֵר הַבְּרִית כַּיָּדוּעַ. **and a righteous person is defined as one who preserves the Covenant, as is known.** אֲבָל הַכָּתוּב הֵעִיד דְּכוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים, **Nevertheless, Scripture bore witness that "they are all righteous",** שֶׁאֲרִית יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק "וְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאִים עַל שֵׁם יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק", **and all Israel are designated by the name of Joseph the Righteous as "the remnant of Joseph",** וַאֲפִילּוּ עַרְלֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאִים מוּלִים, **and even uncircumcised Jews are halakhically categorized as circumcised,** וְכָל הָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת עֲרֵלִים, אֲפִילּוּ הַמּוּלִים, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּנָדָרִים (לא עמוד ב),[10] **while all idolaters are classed as uncircumcised, even if surgically circumcised, as stated in Nedarim (31b),** וְזֶהוּ אוֹת הַבְּרִית הַמַּבְדִּיל בֵּין יִשְׂרָאֵל לָעַמִּים, **and this is the sign of the Covenant separating Israel from the nations,** וְנִתְבָּרְרוּ בְּגָלוּת מִצְרַיִם. **and they were refined and clarified during the Egyptian exile.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר: "יָדֹעַ תֵּדַע וְגוֹמֵר", **And concerning this Hashem answered: "Know of a surety, etc.",** דְּשָׁם יִתְוַודַּע וְיִתְבָּרֵר קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **for there the inner holiness of Israel would be made manifest and fully clarified.**

וְיָדוּעַ מַחֲלוֹקֶת רִאשׁוֹנִים אִי הָאָבוֹת יָצְאוּ מִכְּלַל בְּנֵי נֹחַ, **And known is the dispute among early authorities whether the Patriarchs departed from the halakhic status of Noahides,** וְאִלּוּ וְאִלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים, **and both opinions are the words of the living God:** דְּמִכְּלַל בְּנֵי נֹחַ יָצְאוּ, **for from the baseline status of Noahides they certainly exited,** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם נִקְרָא בַּחֲגִיגָה (ג עמוד א) "תְּחִלָּה לַגֵּרִים",[11] **and our father Abraham, peace be upon him, is titled in Chagigah (3a) "the first of converts",** אֲבָל לְכְלַל יִשְׂרָאֵל לְגַמְרֵי לֹא בָּאוּ עַד מַתַּן תּוֹרָה **yet into the full legal status of Israel they did not enter until the Giving of the Torah,** שֶׁהָיָה קִדּוּשִׁין, **wherein they became consecrated as a holy bride,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין (נט עמוד א) עַל פָּסוּק "תּוֹרָה צִוָּה לָנוּ מֹשֶׁה מוֹרָשָׁה קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב" – מְאוֹרָסָה.[12] **as stated in Sanhedrin (59a) on the verse "Torah which Moses commanded us is an inheritance (morashah) of the congregation of Jacob" – read rather me'orasah, betrothed.** וְאַבְרָהָם הוּבְטַח בָּזֶה בִּשְׁבוּעָה, **And Abraham was assured of this through an oath,** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שִׁידּוּכִין וְהִתְקַשְּׁרוּת בִּשְׁבוּעָה, **which is akin to an engagement and mutual commitment made under oath,** אֲבָל עֲדַיִן אֶפְשָׁר לְהִנָּתֵק עַד הַנִּשּׂוּאִין שֶׁנִּגְמְרוּ הַשִּׁידּוּכִין. **yet it could still be severed until the nuptial wedding when the match is fully finalized.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "וְיִדַּעְתֶּם אֶת נֶפֶשׁ הַגֵּר כִּי גֵרִים הֱיִיתֶם בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם", **And regarding this it is said: "And you know the soul of a stranger, for you were strangers in the land of Egypt",** שֶׁהָיוּ אָז דּוּגְמַת נֶפֶשׁ הַגֵּר, **for they then held the spiritual status of a convert's soul,** דֶּרֶק בְּשֵׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל יְכֻנֶּה. **who is merely designated by the generic appellation of Israel.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי גֵר יִהְיֶה זַרְעֲךָ וְגוֹמֵר", **And this is what Scripture means: "For your seed shall be a stranger, etc.",** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה "וַעֲבָדוּם וְגוֹמֵר", **and through this "and they shall serve them, etc.",** יוּכְלוּ לְשׁלוֹט לְשַׁעְבְּדָם, **the Egyptians were able to dominate and enslave them,** דַּעֲדַיִן לֹא נִקְרְאוּ עַבְדֵי ה' וּבָנִים לַמָּקוֹם. **since they were not yet termed servants of Hashem and children unto the**

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[10] **Chagigah 3a**: "Rava expounded: What does "How beautiful are your steps in sandals, daughter of the generous one" mean? How beautiful are Israel's feet when they ascend for the pilgrimage festival. "Daughter of the generous one" means the daughter of our father Abraham, who was called generous, as it says, "The generous among the peoples gathered, the people of Abraham's God." Why "Abraham's God," rather than the God of Isaac and Jacob? Because Abraham was the first of the converts."

[11] **Sanhedrin 59a**: "R. Yohanan said: A gentile who engages in Torah incurs the death penalty, as it says, "Moses commanded us the Torah as an inheritance"—an inheritance for us, not for them. Why is this not counted among the seven commandments? According to the reading "inheritance," he is stealing it; according to the reading "betrothed," his judgment is like that of violating a betrothed young woman, which is stoning. They raised an objection: R. Meir used to say: From where do we know that even a gentile who engages in Torah is like a High Priest? It says, "Which a human being shall perform and live through them." It does not say "priests, Levites, and Israelites," but "a human being." Thus even a gentile who engages in Torah is like a High Priest. That statement concerns their own seven commandments."

[12] Parallel: **Pri Tzaddik, Bechukotai 11:1**: "All the good things, and likewise all the rebukes stated in the Torah, serve only as assistance in His service. If "you walk in My statutes," assistance comes through this world's good things; if, Heaven forbid, "you reject My statutes," assistance comes through this world's rebukes and sufferings. David said, "Your rod and Your staff comfort me": "Your rod" means sufferings, while "Your staff" means good things; both guide me toward the good and upright path. Suffering is only like a father disciplining his son to guide him toward goodness. Thus the Sages explain why the public reading of the curses is not interrupted: "My son, do not reject Hashem's discipline." It resembles a father raising his rod to discipline his son: the son immediately returns to the good path, and no further discipline is needed."

Connection: Bechukotai distinguishes the purpose of rebuke from retribution: both prosperity and suffering assist divine service, and even the father's raised rod can suffice to awaken return.

Omnipresent. וְעַל יְדֵי הֶעְבְּדוּת זָכוּ לְהִתְגַּלּוּת הַגְּאוּלָה אַחַר כָּךְ וְקַבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה. **And through this very servitude they merited the revelation of the redemption afterward and the reception of the Torah.**

דְּעִינּוּיִים וְיִסּוּרִין שֶׁלָּהֶם אֵינוֹ כְּיִסּוּרֵי הָעַמִּים שֶׁהוּא לְהַאֲבִידָם, **For their afflictions and sufferings were not like the afflictions of the nations which are to destroy them,** "כַּאֲשֶׁר יְיַסֵּר אִישׁ אֶת בְּנוֹ וְגוֹמֵר "אֲבָל אֶל יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא **, rather toward Israel it is "as a man chastises his son, etc.",** שֶׁהוּא לְאַהֲבָתוֹ וּמִצַּד חַסְדּוֹ וְטוּבוֹ **which stems from His love and from His lovingkindness and goodness,** שֶׁאֵין יָכוֹל עֲדַיִן לְהֵיטִיב לוֹ וְצָרִיךְ לְיַסְּרוֹ וּלְהוֹכִיחוֹ, **because He cannot yet bestow boundless goodness directly and must first purify and rebuke him,** דְּעַל יְדֵי זֶה יוּכַל לְקַבֵּל אַחַר כָּךְ רוֹב טוּבָה. **so that through this he can subsequently receive the abundance of good.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "כָּל הַמַּחֲלָה אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּמִצְרַיִם לֹא... כִּי אֲנִי ה' רֹפְאֶךָ", **And regarding this Scripture states: "Every sickness which I put upon Egypt I will not... for I am Hashem your healer",** וְאִם אֵין מַכָּה, רְפוּאָה לָמָּה? **and if there is no stroke, why mention a cure?** אֲבָל הַכַּוָּנָה: אַף שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מַכָּה, אֵינוֹ כַּמַּחֲלָה בְּמִצְרַיִם שֶׁהָיָה לְהַכּוֹתָם וּלְכַלּוֹתָם בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין, **Rather the meaning is: even should there be a wound, it is not like the sickness in Egypt which was to smite and annihilate them under strict judgment,** וְזֶה לֹא אָשִׂים עָלֶיךָ; **and this destructive plague I will never place upon you;** רַק כְּשֶׁיִּגִּיעַ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם עֲלֵיכֶם, תֵּדַע כִּי אֲנִי ה' – שֵׁם הֶוְיָ"ה שֶׁהוּא מִצַּד מִדַּת הָרַחֲמִים **– only when it arrives upon you, Heaven forbid, know that I am Hashem—using the Tetragrammaton which embodies the attribute of mercy—** וְאֲנִי רוֹפְאֶךָ בָּזֶה, **and I am healing you through this,** וּכְרוֹפֵא הַמַּכְאִיב עַל יְדֵי הָרְפוּאוֹת, וְהוּא מְקֻבָּל בְּאַהֲבָה וְחִיבָּה **operating like a physician who causes pain during the medical treatment, which the patient accepts with love and affection** שֶׁיּוֹדֵעַ שֶׁאֵינוֹ רוֹצֶה לְיַסְּרוֹ וּלְהַכּוֹתוֹ, רַק לְהֵיטִיב לוֹ עַל יְדֵי זֶה.[13] **knowing that the doctor does not desire to torment or injure him, but solely to bring about his healing through this.**

וְזֶהוּ פָּרָשַׁת שְׁמוֹת, שֶׁהוּא הַגָּלוּת שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי מִדַּת הַחֶסֶד לְאַבְרָהָם, **And this is Parashat Shemot, which is the exile that came about via the attribute of Chesed promised to Abraham,** וְהוּא הַחֶרֶב פִּיפִיּוֹת בְּיָדָם שֶׁרוֹמֵז גַּם כֵּן עַל שְׁנַּעֲשֵׂית הַמִּילָה **and it is the "two-edged sword in their hand" which likewise alludes to the circumcision** עַל יְדֵי חֶרֶב פִּיפִיּוֹת וְנִיתְּנָה לְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, **which is performed with a sharp blade and was gifted to our father Abraham, peace be upon him,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה מְנַצְּחִים לְכָל הָאוּמּוֹת וּלְחַרְבָּא דְּעֵשָׂו שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הָאוּמּוֹת, **and through this they conquer all the nations and the sword of Esau which is the root of the nations,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "רֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִם עֲמָלֵק", **as it is written: "First among the nations was Amalek",** וְהוּא מָאַס הַמִּילָה שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הָעֶרְלָה דְּעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת עֲרֵלִים. **and he despised circumcision, being the spiritual root of uncircumcision where idolaters are classified as uncircumcised.** וּבְמִצְרַיִם הָיָה הַשִּׁעְבּוּד עַל יְדֵי שֶׁבִּיטְּלוּ הַמִּילָה, **And in Egypt the enslavement began because they neglected circumcision,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ דְּנַעֲשׂוּ לְמַרְאִית הָעַיִן כְּכָל הַגּוֹיִם, **as written in the Midrash, that they appeared to outward sight like all the gentiles,** וְלָכֵן נֶאֱמַר "גּוֹי מִקֶּרֶב גּוֹי" כְּעֻבָּר בִּמְעֵי אִמּוֹ **, and therefore Scripture says "a nation from the midst of a nation", like an embryo in the womb of its mother,** שֶׁזּוּהֲמַת מִצְרַיִם הָיְתָה מַקֶּפֶת אוֹתָם, וְעֻבָּר יֶרֶךְ אִמּוֹ. **for the defilement of**

[13] **Eruvin 19a**: “Thus Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: What is meant by “Those passing through the valley of weeping make it a spring; the teacher is also clothed in blessings”? “Those passing” are people who transgress the will of the Holy One, blessed be He. “The valley”—Gehinnom is deepened for them. “Weeping”—they weep and shed tears like a spring flowing into the depths. “The teacher is also clothed in blessings”—they accept their judgment as just, saying: Master of the world, You have judged well, acquitted well, condemned well, and rightly prepared Gehinnom for the wicked and Eden for the righteous. Is that so? Reish Lakish said: The wicked do not repent even at Gehinnom’s entrance, as it says, “They shall go out and see the corpses of the people who rebel against Me.” It does not say “who rebelled,” but “who rebel,” meaning that they continue rebelling forever. There is no difficulty: One statement concerns Israel’s sinners, the other the sinners of the nations. This is also reasonable, since otherwise Reish Lakish would contradict himself. Reish Lakish said: Gehinnom’s fire does not rule over Israel’s sinners. This follows all the more from the golden altar: Though covered by only a dinar’s thickness of gold, it stood for many years without fire ruling over it. How much more so Israel’s sinners, who are filled with mitzvot like a pomegranate! For “Your temples are like a slice of pomegranate” may be read, “Even your empty ones are filled with mitzvot like a pomegranate.” What then of “Those passing through the valley of weeping”? It concerns those liable to Gehinnom at that time; Abraham comes, raises them out, and receives them—except an Israelite who had relations with a gentile woman, whose foreskin extends so that Abraham does not recognize him. Rav Kahana challenged: Since you interpret “who rebel” as ongoing rebellion, would “who brought out” and “who brought up” also mean that He continually brings out and brings up? Rather, these refer to His having brought out and brought up; here too the verse can refer to their having rebelled.”

Egypt was encircling them, and an embryo is considered the thigh of its mother. אֲבָל רַק בִּהְיוֹתוֹ בְּמֵעָיו, **Yet this applies only while it remains in her womb,** וְגַם אָז עַצְמוּתוֹ חֲיוּתוֹ אַחֵר, וְסוֹפוֹ לִהְיוֹת בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ. **and even then its essential vitality is distinct, and it is destined to emerge on its own.**

Now Egypt was the nakedness of the land and steeped in licentiousness, וּמִצְרַיִם עֶרְוַת הָאָרֶץ וּשְׁטוּפֵי זִמָּה, **which is why the exile was specifically sent there: to clarify that Israel are not like them,** דְּעַל כֵּן הָיְתָה הַגָּלוּת לְשָׁם – לְבָרֵר שֶׁהֵם אֵינָם כְּמוֹתָם. **for they remained strictly barricaded against sexual immorality as our Sages of blessed memory noted.** דְּהֵם הָיוּ גְּדוּרִים בַּעֲרָיוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה. **And this was through the spiritual power of Joseph who safeguarded himself from licentiousness there,** וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי יוֹסֵף שֶׁנִּגְדַּר שָׁם מֵעֶרְוָה, **and all Israel were preserved in purity through his merit,** וְנִגְדְּרוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּזְכוּתוֹ, **because all Israel are one organic entity.** כִּי כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל גּוּי אֶחָד. **And because Joseph brought an evil report of his brothers that they cast their eyes upon the daughters of the land,** וּלְפִי שֶׁיּוֹסֵף הוֹצִיא דִּבַּת אֶחָיו דְּנוֹתְנִים עֵינֵיהֶם בִּבְנוֹת הָאָרֶץ (יט עַמּוּד א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּעֵירוּבִין "הַבּוֹעֵל אֲרַמִּית מְמַשְׁכָּא עָרְלָתוֹ", דְּ"הַבּוֹעֵל אֲרַמִּית, שֶׁנָּזְהוּ עִיקַּר פְּגַם הַבְּרִית,[14] **which is the core blemish of the Covenant, for "he who cohabits with a gentile woman draws out his foreskin" as written in Eruvin (19a), and thus Joseph stumbled through speech;** וְחָטָא הוּא בַּלָּשׁוֹן; וּבְרִית הַלָּשׁוֹן נֶגֶד בְּרִית הַמָּעוֹר, **and the Covenant of the Tongue corresponds directly to the Covenant of the Flesh, as it is written regarding Er: "he was evil in the sight of Hashem", as is known.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּעֵר: "רַע בְּעֵינֵי ה'" כַּיָּדוּעַ. **since the blemish of both is designated as "evil",** דְּפִגַּם שְׁנֵיהֶם נִקְרָא "רַע", **Similarly, slander is designated as "evil",** וְכֵן לָשׁוֹן הָרָע נִקְרָא "רַע". **and they expounded on "the law of the leper (metzora)" – one who brings forth an evil name (motzi ra).** וְאָמְרוּ עַל פִּי "תּוֹרַת הַמְּצֹרָע" – הַמּוֹצִיא שֵׁם רָע. **And the rectification of both is Torah study,** וְתִיקּוּן שְׁנֵיהֶם תּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּלָשׁוֹן הָרָע: מַאי תִּקְנְתֵיהּ? יַעֲסֹק בַּתּוֹרָה, **as it is written regarding slander: What is his remedy? Let him engage in Torah,** דִּכְתִיב "מַרְפֵּא לָשׁוֹן עֵץ חַיִּים". **as it is written: "A soothing tongue is a tree of life".** וּ"מָוֶת וְחַיִּים בְּיַד לָשׁוֹן", **And "Death and life are in the power of the tongue",** וְלָשׁוֹן הָרָע נִקְרָא מָוֶת, **and slander is titled death,** וְכֵן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית הֵבִיא הַמִּיתָה, **and likewise the blemish of the Covenant brought mortality into the world,** דְּעִיקַּר חֵטְא אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן הָיָה **for the primary essence of the sin of Adam the First was** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה מָשׁוּךְ בְּעָרְלָתוֹ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין (לח עַמּוּד ב)[15] **that through it he became drawn out in his foreskin as stated in Sanhedrin (38b) from the verse "Like Adam they transgressed the covenant",** מִקְּרָא דְּ"כְּאָדָם עָבְרוּ בְרִית". עַל יְדֵי הַזּוּהֲמָא שֶׁהֵטִיל בְּחַוָּה. **via the spiritual defilement that the serpent cast into Eve.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הוֹלִיד אוֹתָן מֵאָה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה רוּחִין וְשֵׁדִין וְלֵילִין בְּהוֹצָאַת זֶרַע לְבַטָּלָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּעֵירוּבִין (יח עַמּוּד ב).[16] **And through this he fathered during those 130 years spirits, demons, and night-specters through the emission of semen in vain, as written in Eruvin (18b).**

And it is known that these very sparks were the souls exiled in Egypt, וְיָדוּעַ דְּהֵם הַנְּפָשׁוֹת דְּגָלוּת מִצְרַיִם **who were required to rectify this through immersion amidst the defilement of Egypt** שֶׁהוּצְרְכוּ לְתַקֵּן זֶה עַל יְדֵי הַהִשְׁתַּקְּעוּת בְּזוּהֲמַת מִצְרַיִם וְהֵם גְּדוּרִים בַּעֲרָיוֹת, **while remaining hermetically guarded against sexual**

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[14] **Sanhedrin 38b**: “Rav Judah said in Rav’s name: Adam was a heretic, as it says, “Hashem God called to the human being and said to him, Where are you?”—where has your heart turned? R. Isaac said: He drew his foreskin forward. Here it says, “Like Adam, they transgressed the covenant,” and elsewhere it says, “He has broken My covenant.””

[15] **Eruvin 18b**: “Rabbi Yirmeya ben Elazar said: During all the years that Adam was under ban, he fathered spirits, demons, and night-demons, as it says, “Adam lived one hundred and thirty years and fathered a son in his likeness, according to his image.” This implies that before then he did not father beings in his image. An objection was raised: Rabbi Meir used to say: Adam was a great pious man. When he saw that death had been decreed through him, he fasted for one hundred and thirty years, separated from his wife for one hundred and thirty years, and placed a girdle of fig leaves upon his body for one hundred and thirty years. The earlier statement concerns semen that he emitted involuntarily.”

[16] **Shabbat 146a**: “Why are the nations tainted? Because they did not stand at Mount Sinai. When the serpent came upon Eve, it implanted pollution in her. Israel, who stood at Mount Sinai, had their pollution cease; the nations, who did not stand at Mount Sinai, did not have their pollution cease. Rav Aha, Rava’s son, asked Rav Ashi: What about converts? He answered: Though they themselves were not there, their heavenly roots were there, as it says, “Those standing here with us today before the Lord our God, and those who are not here.” This disagrees with Rabbi Abba bar Kahana, who said: The pollution did not cease from our ancestors until three generations had passed. Abraham fathered Ishmael; Isaac fathered Esau; Jacob fathered twelve tribes among whom there was no flaw.”

immorality, (קמו עמוד א) וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכוּ לַהֲסָרַת הַזּוּהֲמָא בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּשַׁבָּת.[17] **and through this they merited the permanent removal of that primal defilement at the Giving of the Torah, as written in Shabbat (146a).** וּלְחַד מַאן דְּאָמַר שָׁם בְּיַעֲקֹב פָּסְקָה, **And according to one authority there, in Jacob the defilement ceased,** וְאִלּוּ וְאִלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים, **and both opinions are the words of the living God:** וּבְיַעֲקֹב עַצְמוֹ פָּסְקָה לְגַמְרֵי, דְּעַל כֵּן לֹא מֵת, **for in Jacob himself it ceased completely, which is why he never died,** אֲבָל אַף דְּמִטָּתוֹ שְׁלֵימָה, **yet even though his bed was complete,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם לֹא הָיָה עֲדַיִן בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת עַד מַתַּן תּוֹרָה. **nonetheless it had not yet emerged into manifest revelation until the Giving of the Torah.** וּבְמִצְרַיִם, שֶׁהָיוּ כְּעֻבָּר דְּיֶרֶךְ אִמּוֹ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, **And in Egypt, where they were like an embryo which is the thigh of its mother as mentioned above,** לֹא נִתְגַּלָּה קְדוּשָׁתָם, **their inherent holiness was not openly apparent,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה טָעָה יוֹסֵף בַּשְּׁבָטִים כְּפוֹגְמֵי הַבְּרִית, **and through this disguise Joseph erred regarding the tribes, suspecting them of blemishing the Covenant,** לְעֻבָּד נִמְכַּר יוֹסֵף "וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה", **and as a consequence "Joseph was sold as a slave",** כִּי הֵם חָשְׁבוּ דְּמִסְתָּמָא כָּל הַפּוֹסֵל בְּמוּמוֹ פּוֹסֵל. **because the brothers assumed that naturally whoever invalidates another does so reflecting his own flaw.** עַד כָּאן מִכְּתַב יַד קָדְשׁוֹ, וְחָסֵר הַסִּיּוּם: **Until here from his holy handwritten manuscript, and the conclusion is missing:**

Shemos — V'eleh Shemos "וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מַאֲמַר"

"וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הַבָּאִים מִצְרַיְמָה וְגוֹמֵר". **"Now these are the names of the children of Israel who came into Egypt, etc."** בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה א׳, א׳) וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (א׳) פָּתְחָה פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **In Shemot Rabbah 1:1 and Midrash Tanchuma, Shemot 1, this parashah opens** בְּפָסוּק "חוֹשֵׂךְ שִׁבְטוֹ וְגוֹמֵר וְאוֹהֲבוֹ שִׁחֲרוֹ מוּסָר".[18] **with the verse "He that spares his rod hates his son, but he that loves him disciplines him early".** וְרָמְזוּ בָּזֶה שֶׁכָּל עִנְיַן גְּלוּת מִצְרַיִם הָיָה הֲכָנָה לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה, **And they alluded by this that the whole matter of the Egyptian exile was a preparation for the Giving of the Torah,** שֶׁזָּכוּ עַל יְדֵי אַהֲבַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **which they merited through the deep love of Hashem, blessed be He,** וְזָכוּ עַל יְדֵי הַיִּסּוּרִין שֶׁל גָּלוּת מִצְרַיִם **and which they merited through the purifying afflictions of the Egyptian exile** "וְאוֹהֲבוֹ שִׁחֲרוֹ מוּסָר": עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר. **along the lines of what is said: "and he that loves him disciplines him early".**

"וְהַגָּלוּת מַתְחִיל מִפָּסוּק "וַיָּקָם מֶלֶךְ חָדָשׁ", **And the actual exile begins from the verse "Now there arose a new king",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה א׳, ח׳) עַל פָּסוּק "וַיָּמָת יוֹסֵף וְגוֹמֵר", **and as it is written in Shemot Rabbah 1:8 on the verse "And Joseph died, etc.",** שֶׁכָּל זְמַן שֶׁהָיָה אֶחָד מֵהֶם קַיָּם מֵאוֹתָן שֶׁיָּרְדוּ לְמִצְרַיִם, **that as long as even one of those who had descended to Egypt remained alive,** לֹא שִׁעְבְּדוּ הַמִּצְרִים בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל.[19] **the Egyptians did not subjugate the Jewish people.** וְגַם לְפִשּׁוּטוֹ, בְּוַדַּאי כָּל זְמַן שֶׁהָיָה יוֹסֵף קַיָּם וְהָיָה מוֹשֵׁל בָּאָרֶץ, **Moreover according to the plain sense, surely as long as Joseph lived and ruled over the land,** לֹא מָלֵא לֵב אֶחָד מֵהַמִּצְרִים לְשַׁעְבֵּד בְּאֶחָיו. **not a single one of the Egyptians dared presume to enslave his brothers.** וּמַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת וַיְחִי (צ״ו, א׳)) **And regarding what is written (Bereishit Rabbah 96:1, beginning of Parashat Vayechi)** כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּפְטַר אָבִינוּ יַעֲקֹב הִתְחִילָה שִׁעְבּוּד מִצְרַיִם עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל –[20] **that once our father**

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[17] **Midrash Tanchuma, Shemot 1**: "'These are the names.' Thus Scripture says, 'One who withholds his rod hates his son, but one who loves him seeks discipline for him early.' Ordinarily, if one person tells another, 'So-and-so struck your son,' the father pursues that man to the utmost. Why, then, does Scripture say, 'One who withholds his rod hates his son'? To teach that whoever withholds discipline from his son will ultimately see him take a corrupt path and come to hate him."

Shemot Rabbah 1:1: ""These are the names of the children of Israel who came to Egypt with Jacob; each man came with his household." This is what Scripture says: "One who withholds his rod hates his son, but one who loves him disciplines him early." Ordinarily, if someone tells a man, "So-and-so struck your son," he becomes his bitter enemy. What, then, does "One who withholds his rod hates his son" teach? Whoever withholds discipline from his son will ultimately see him fall into evil ways, and will hate him."

[18] **Shemot Rabbah 1:8**: ""Joseph died, and all his brothers, and that entire generation." This teaches that as long as any one of those who had descended to Egypt remained alive, the Egyptians did not enslave Israel."

[19] **Bereshit Rabbah 96:1**: "'Jacob lived in the land of Egypt.' Why is this section closed, unlike the other Torah sections? Once our father Jacob died, Israel's enslavement in Egypt began. Another interpretation: Why is it closed? Because our father Jacob wished to reveal the end of the exile, but it was concealed from him. Another interpretation: Why is it closed? Because God closed off from him all the troubles of the world."

[20] **Peri Tzadik, Vayechi 5**: "When Jacob died, bondage began: they began feeling the evil inclination's bondage through Egypt's shell, and the labor of struggling against it began. Rashi therefore says that when Jacob our father died,

Jacob passed away the Egyptian subjugation over Israel began – הֵיינוּ שֶׁעָבוּד הַגָּפֶשׁ, **this refers to the spiritual subjugation of the soul,** שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁוּ אָז בְּנַפְשָׁם מִקְּלִיפַּת מִצְרַיִם **which they began to feel within their inner psyche from the impure husk of Egypt (**כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר וַיְחִי מַאֲמָר ה). ([21]**as explained in Parashat Vayechi, discourse 5).**

וְהִנֵּה בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה (פָּרָשָׁה ג) אִיתָא, **And behold in Bereishit Rabbah (parashah 3) it is taught,** דַּחֲמֵשׁ פְּעָמִים כְּנֶגֶד "אוֹרָה שֶׁבַּמַּאֲמָר "יְהִי אוֹר" **that the five occurrences of light in the divine utterance "Let there be light"** חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה.[22] **correspond to the Five Books of the Torah.** וְהֵם כְּנֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה פַּרְצוּפִין, **And they correspond to the five Kabbalistic Partzufim,** שֶׁהֵם כְּנֶגֶד אַרְבַּע אוֹתִיּוֹת הַשֵּׁם הַוָיָ"ה וְקוֹצוֹ שֶׁל יוּ"ד דְּרַמְיָא לְאֵין, **which align with the four letters of the Tetragrammaton and the cusp of the Yod which alludes to Ayin (Nothingness),** שֶׁהוּא פַּרְצוּף אֲרִיךְ אַנְפִּין כַּיָּדוּעַ. **which is the Partzuf of Arich Anpin as is known.** וְנֶגֶד זֶה (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יד) הֵם חָמֵשׁ מַדְרֵגוֹת שֶׁבְּנֶפֶשׁ שֶׁנִּתְחַשְּׁבוּ,[23] **And corresponding to this are the five soul-levels enumerated in Bereishit Rabbah (parashah 14),** וְכָל אֶחָד כְּלוּל מֵעֶשֶׂר כַּיָּדוּעַ. **and each one is subdivided into ten as is known.** וְסֵפֶר וַיִּקְרָא וּבַמִּדְבָּר הֵם שֶׁל עֶשֶׂר פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת, **And the Book of Vayikra and Bemidbar consist of ten weekly parashiyot each,** וְכֵן דְּבָרִים גַּם כֵּן עֶשֶׂר פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת **and likewise Devarim consists of ten parashiyot,** דְּפָרָשַׁת "וְזֹאת הַבְּרָכָה" אֵינוֹ מַחֲשְׁבוֹן נ"ג פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת **since Parashat Vezot Haberakhah is not counted within the standard cycle of 53 sabbaths** וְאֵינוֹ נִקְרָא בְּשַׁבָּת מִטַּעַם זֶה. **and is not read on the regular weekly Shabbat for this reason.** רַק סֵפֶר בְּרֵאשִׁית בּוֹ שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת, **Only the Book of Bereishit contains twelve parashiyot,** וְסֵפֶר שְׁמוֹת בּוֹ אַחַת עֶשְׂרֵה פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת. **and the Book of Shemot contains eleven parashiyot.**

וְהִנֵּה בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה (ג׳, ה׳) אָמְרוּ: "יְהִי אוֹר" – כְּנֶגֶד סֵפֶר בְּרֵאשִׁית, **Now in Bereishit Rabbah 3:5 they taught: "Let there be light" corresponds to the Book of Bereishit,** שֶׁבּוֹ נִתְעַסֵּק הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וּבָרָא אֶת עוֹלָמוֹ.[24] **wherein the Holy One, blessed be He, engaged and created His world.** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁעִיקָּרוֹ מַתְחִיל מִפָּרָשַׁת לֶךְ לְךָ, **And we have explained that its core dynamic actually begins from Parashat Lech Lecha,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ רַבָּה ב׳, ג׳): "יְהִי אוֹר" – זֶה אַבְרָהָם,[25] **and in the manner of their teaching (Bereishit Rabbah 2:3): "Let there**

Israel's eyes and hearts were closed through the distress of bondage. The Zohar likewise says, 'When Jacob died, Israel's eyes were closed.' Their eyes allude to wisdom in the brain, from which the eyes are rooted; therefore the Sanhedrin and Israel's sages are called the congregation's eyes. Their hearts mean understanding in the heart. Through the shell, Israel's springs of wisdom and understanding were closed, and the bondage of Egypt's shell entered heart and brain."

[21] **Bereshit Rabbah 3:5**: "Rabbi Simon said: Light is mentioned here five times, corresponding to the five books of the Torah. 'God said, Let there be light' corresponds to Genesis, with which the Holy One, blessed be He, occupied Himself in creating His world. 'And there was light' corresponds to Exodus, in which Israel emerged from darkness into light. 'God saw that the light was good' corresponds to Leviticus, which is filled with many laws. 'God separated the light from the darkness' corresponds to Numbers, which distinguishes those who left Egypt from those who entered the Land. 'God called the light day' corresponds to Deuteronomy, which is filled with many laws. The companions objected to Rabbi Simon: 'But Leviticus is already filled with many laws!' He replied: 'Deuteronomy repeats a matter as well.'"

[22] **Bereshit Rabbah 14:9**: "The soul is called by five names: nefesh, ruach, neshamah, yechidah, and chayyah. Nefesh is the blood, as it says, 'For the blood is the nefesh.' Ruach ascends and descends, as it says, 'Who knows whether the spirit of human beings ascends upward?' Neshamah is one's disposition, as people say, 'His disposition is good.' It is called chayyah because all the limbs are lifeless, while it lives within the body; and yechidah because all the limbs come in pairs, while it is alone within the body."

[23] **Bereshit Rabbah 3:5**: "Rabbi Simon said: Light is mentioned here five times, corresponding to the five books of the Torah. 'God said, Let there be light' corresponds to Genesis, with which the Holy One, blessed be He, occupied Himself in creating His world. 'And there was light' corresponds to Exodus, in which Israel emerged from darkness into light. 'God saw that the light was good' corresponds to Leviticus, which is filled with many laws. 'God separated the light from the darkness' corresponds to Numbers, which distinguishes those who left Egypt from those who entered the Land. 'God called the light day' corresponds to Deuteronomy, which is filled with many laws. The companions objected to Rabbi Simon: 'But Leviticus is already filled with many laws!' He replied: 'Deuteronomy repeats a matter as well.'"

[24] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:3**: "The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'How long shall the world continue in darkness? Let light come!' 'God said, Let there be light' refers to Abraham, as it says, 'Who aroused righteousness from the east?' Read not he'ir, 'aroused,' but he'ir, 'illuminated.'"

[25] **Shemot Rabbah 30:13**: "'"A man of exactions ruins it"—this is the generation of the Flood, who did not practice justice. See what is written concerning them: "They drive away the orphans' donkey; they turn the needy away from the road." Rabbi Acha said: The Holy One, blessed be He, wished to give them four things: Torah, suffering,

be light" – this is Abraham, וְאָז הִתְחִיל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם לְהָאִיר וּלְפָרְסֵם אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, **and then our father Abraham, peace be upon him, began to radiate and disseminate His divinity, blessed be He,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִזְכַּר כָּל לֵידַת הָאָבוֹת וּשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים **and afterward the narrative records the births of the Patriarchs and the twelve tribes** "וַיִּישָׂם בָּאָרוֹן בְּמִצְרָיִם", **until it concludes "and he was put in a coffin in Egypt",** שֶׁאָז נִשְׁלַם בֵּירוּר כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּבְחִינַת יוֹסֵף, **whereby the clarification of the Congregation of Israel was perfected in the aspect of Joseph,** וְזֶה תַּשְׁלוּם בְּרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם בְּעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת. **and this constitutes the completion of Creation across the ten parashiyot corresponding to the ten sefirot.**

וּמִקּוֹדֶם לָזֶה בָּאוּ שְׁתֵּי פָּרָשִׁיוֹת בְּרֵאשִׁית נֹחַ שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵי אֲלָפִים תֹּהוּ **And prior to this came the first two parashiyot, Bereishit and Noach, facing the 2,000 years of Chaos** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאַר רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת וַיִּשְׁלַח), **(as explained at the beginning of Parashat Vayishlach),** וְשָׁם נִזְכַּר דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל **and there is recorded the Generation of the Flood,** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ל', י"ג) שֶׁהֵם כְּנֶגֶד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב שֶׁהָיְתָה רָאוּי לִיתֵּן לְדוֹר הַמַּבּוּל כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב,[26] **who corresponded to the Written Torah which was originally fit to be given to them as written (Shemot Rabbah 30:13),** וְהַתְחָלַת דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל נִזְכָּר בְּפָרָשַׁת בְּרֵאשִׁית. **and the inception of the Generation of the Flood is mentioned in Parashat Bereishit.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ דּוֹר הַפְּלָגָה **And afterward occurred the Generation of Dispersion,** שֶׁהָיָה בְּזֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה נֶגֶד שֶׁעִיקַּר הִתְפַּשְׁטוּתָהּ בְּבָבֶל **which stood in corrupted opposition facing the Oral Torah** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **whose primary geographic expansion took place in Babylonia,** וְלָכֵן כְּשֶׁהִרְגִּישׁוּ מִזֶּה **and therefore when they sensed this potential,** (וְנִתְבָּאַר רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת נֹחַ) רָצוּ לְהַעֲמִיד הַמִּגְדָּל שֶׁהוּא בְּזֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה נֶגֶד הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, **they sought to erect the Tower of Babel in illicit imitation of the Holy Temple (as explained in Parashat Noach),** וְזֶה נִזְכָּר בְּפָרָשַׁת נֹחַ. **and this is recorded in Parashat Noach.** וְהֵם כְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵי אֲלָפִים תֹּהוּ, **And these correspond to the 2,000 years of Chaos,** וְהֵם הֲכָנָה לְסֵפֶר בְּרֵאשִׁית **and they serve as the prelude to the true narrative of Genesis** שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ הִתְחִיל הַשְּׁנֵי **which faces "Let there be light – this is Abraham"** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד "יְהִי אוֹר – זֶה אַבְרָהָם אֲלָפִים תּוֹרָה. **from whom commenced the 2,000 years of Torah.**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ "וַיְהִי אוֹר" – כְּנֶגֶד סֵפֶר שְׁמוֹת, **And afterward "And there was light" corresponds to the Book of Shemot,** שֶׁבּוֹ יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה. **in which Israel emerged from darkness into radiant light as written in Bereishit Rabbah.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר גַּם כֵּן שֶׁעִיקָּרוֹ מַתְחִיל מִפָּרָשַׁת וָאֵרָא, **And it can likewise be said that its core dynamic begins from Parashat Va'era,** דְּשָׁם כְּבָר הוּזְכְּרוּ הַשֶּׁבַע מַכּוֹת **for there are already enumerated the seven plagues** נָגוֹף – שֶׁהֵם הָיוּ נָגוֹף וְרָפוֹא **– which operated as smiting and healing –** לְמִצְרַיִם וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, **smiting for Egypt and healing for Israel,** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁדָּרְשׁוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב, לו עַמּוּד א), **and along the lines of what they expounded (Zohar Part II, 36a),** וְהָיוּ שֶׁבְּכָל מַכָּה יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מִקְּלִיפָּה אַחַת[27] **meaning that with each plague Israel was extricated from one impure husk** וְנִכְנְסוּ בִּקְדוּשָׁה בְּמִדָּה אַחַת שֶׁמִּשֶּׁבַע תַּחְתּוֹנִיּוֹת. **and entered into holiness within one attribute of the seven lower sefirot.**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא בְּשַׁלַּח – גְּמַר יְצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם. **And afterward comes Parashat Beshalach – the ultimate completion of the Exodus from Egypt.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ מַתַּן תּוֹרָה, **And afterward the Giving of the Torah (Parashat Yitro),** שֶׁהָיָה רָאוּי לִיתֵּן כָּךְ בָּא בְּשַׁלַּח – גְּמַר יְצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם

damage of the serpent. וְאַחַר כָּךְ, אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל, **And afterward, following the spiritual ruin of the Golden Calf,** נֶאֱמַר מַעֲשֵׂה הַמִּשְׁכָּן, **there was commanded the construction of the Tabernacle,** שֶׁהָיָה גַּם כֵּן עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **which was likewise accomplished through Moses our teacher, peace be upon him,** לְהַשְׁכִּין הַשְׁכִּינָה בָּאָרֶץ וְאַף בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ. **to cause the Shechinah to dwell on earth, and even outside the Land of Israel.** וְזֶה תַּשְׁלוּם סֵפֶר שְׁמוֹת שֶׁפָּנָיו "וַיְהִי אוֹר" **And this is the consummation of the Book of Shemot facing "And there was light",** שֶׁבּוֹ יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹרָה. **in which Israel emerged from darkness into great light.**

וּבְתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן לוֹ) אִיתָא: "וַיְהִי אוֹר" – דָּא רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה וְכוּלֵי,[28] **And in Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 36) it is stated: "And there was light" – this refers to Rosh Hashanah, etc.,** לְשׁוֹן צַעַר "וַיְהִי". **for the word vayehi denotes sorrow.** וַהֲיָינוּ שֶׁזֶּה מוֹרֶה הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **And this indicates that it signifies the renewal of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁהוּא הָרֹב חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס.[29] **which is the abundance of wisdom that repairs the abundance of vexation.** וּבְמָקוֹם אַחֵר (תִּקּוּן ל) אִיתָא: "וַיְהִי אוֹר" – דָּא שְׂמֹאלָא,[30] **And in another place (Tikkun 30) it is stated: "And there was light" – this is the Left Side (Gevurah),** וְהוּא עַל דָּרְךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: וּמִשְּׂמֹאלָא אִתְיְהִיבַת אוֹרַיְיתָא. **and it aligns with the principle: from the Left was given the Oral Torah, etc.** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב, קסז עַמּוּד א): "וַיְהִי אוֹר" – דְּמִימִינָא נָפִיק שְׂמֹאלָא.[31] **And in the Zohar HaKadosh (Part II, 167a): "And there was light" – from the Right (Chesed) emerges the Left (Gevurah).** וְזֶהוּ מְרַמֵּז עַל לוּחוֹת שְׁנִיִּים, **And this alludes to the Second Tablets of Stone,** שֶׁהָיָה כְּלוּל בָּהֶם מִדְרָשׁ, הֲלָכוֹת, וְאַגָּדוֹת **in which were included Midrash, halakhot, and aggadot,** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה מ״ו, א׳ וּמ״ז, ז׳, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב **as written (Shemot Rabbah 46:1 and 47:7),** כִּי כִּפְלַיִם לְתוּשִׁיָּה וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "כִּי כִּפְלַיִם לְתוּשִׁיָּה".[32] **and regarding this it is stated: "for sound wisdom is double".** וְזֶה סֵדֶר סֵפֶר וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת, **And this is the structural order of the Book of Ve'eleh Shemot,** שֶׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ שֶׁהֵקִים הַמִּשְׁכָּן, **which unfolded through Moses our teacher who erected the Tabernacle,** וְהֵם גַּם כֵּן עֶשֶׂר פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת. **and these likewise constitute ten essential parashiyot.**

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[28] **Ecclesiastes 1:18**: "For abundant wisdom brings abundant vexation, and whoever increases knowledge increases pain."

[29] **Tikkunei Zohar 73a:4-75b:2**: "An elder rose and began: 'Let there be light, and there was light.' 'Let there be light' is the right; 'and there was light' is the left, for vayhi always expresses distress. Therefore 'And it was the day' refers to Rosh Hashanah, the left, which judges the whole world. Because of it, 'And there was light' was said. 'God saw that the light was good' is the middle pillar, which is good. 'God divided between the light and the darkness': the light is Aaron the priest; the darkness is Korach. Moses said, 'It falls to me to resolve the dispute, for I am the likeness of the goodness above.' He saw that Korach clung to the darkness of the Other Side and contradicted creation, refusing to cleave to the left, Levi. He therefore said, 'Separate yourselves from this congregation.'"

[30] **Zohar, Terumah 76:742-77:751**: "Because of the mystery of this light, which burns and illuminates this lamp, Aaron is told, 'When you raise the lamps,' for he comes from this light's side. Of this light it says, 'Let there be light, and there was light.' Once 'Let there be light' was said, why add 'And there was light,' rather than the sufficient 'And it was so'? 'Let there be light' is the primordial light, the right, belonging to the end of the right. 'And there was light' means that the left issued from the right's mystery. Therefore 'And there was light' is the left."

[31] **Shemot Rabbah 46:1**: "He began grieving over the breaking of the tablets. The Holy One, blessed be He, told him: Do not grieve over the first tablets, which contained only the Ten Commandments. In the second tablets I give you, there will be laws, midrash, and aggadot, as it is written, "He will tell you wisdom's hidden things, for sound wisdom is doubled." Moreover, you receive the tidings that I have forgiven your sin, as it says, "Know that God remits some of your iniquity.""

Shemot Rabbah 47:7: "The Holy One, blessed be He, said: You suffered; by your life, you will not lose! The first tablets contained only the Ten Commandments. Now that you have suffered, I give you laws, midrashim, and aggadot, as it says, "Write for yourself these words." Why did the Holy One, blessed be He, say "Write for yourself," when it is written, "The writing was God's writing, engraved upon the tablets," and, "He wrote upon the tablets like the first writing"? Rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, told him: Write Torah, Prophets, and Writings, so that they shall be written; but laws, midrash, aggadot, and the Talmud shall remain oral. When Moses understood, he began saying, "It is good for me that I was afflicted"; "The Torah of Your mouth is good for me.""

[32] **Berakhot 5a**: "A baraita teaches: Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai says that the Holy One, blessed be He, gave Israel three good gifts, all of them through suffering: Torah, the Land of Israel, and the World to Come. What is the source for Torah? "Happy is the man whom You discipline, God, and teach from Your Torah." For the Land of Israel: "As a man disciplines his son, Hashem your God disciplines you," followed by, "For Hashem your God brings you to a good land." For the World to Come: "The commandment is a lamp and Torah is light; the way of life is the reproof of discipline.""

שֶׁבְּפָרָשָׁה זוֹ לֹא נִזְכַּר כְּלָל מְגֹאוּלָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל, **For in this opening parashah (Shemot) the redemption of Israel is not explicitly mentioned at all,** וְאִדְרַבָּה, הַפָּרָשָׁה מְסַיֵּים: "לָמָּה הֲרֵעוֹתָה לָעָם הַזֶּה וְגוֹמֵר וּמֵאָז בָּאתִי וגוֹמֵר הֵרַע לָעָם הַזֶּה". **and on the contrary, the parashah concludes: "Wherefore have You dealt ill with this people, etc., for since I came... he has done evil to this people".** אָכֵן בֶּאֱמֶת, פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ הֲכָנָה לְכָל סֵפֶר שְׁמוֹת "וַיְהִי אוֹר", **Yet in truth, this parashah is the foundational preparation for the entirety of the Book of Shemot, "And there was light",** שֶׁשָּׁם יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹר, **wherein Israel emerged from utter darkness into light,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי גְּלוּת מִצְרַיִם זָכוּ לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה, **since specifically through the exile of Egypt they merited the Giving of the Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בִּבְרָכוֹת ה עַמּוּד א): **as written (Berakhot 5a):** ג' מַתָּנוֹת וְכוּלֵי וְכוּלָּן לֹא נִתְּנָן אֶלָּא עַל יְדֵי יִסּוּרִין: תּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵי, [33] **three good gifts, etc., and all of them were given only through suffering: Torah, etc.,** וְהַתּוֹרָה זָכוּ עַל יְדֵי יִסּוּרֵי גְּלוּת מִצְרַיִם. [34] **and the Torah they merited through the afflictions of the Egyptian exile.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁרָמְזוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ בִּפְתִיחַת פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **And this is what they alluded to in the Midrash at the opening homily of this parashah** מִמַּה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאוֹהֵב שִׁחֲרוֹ מוּסָר". **from that which is stated: "and he that loves him disciplines him early".**

אַךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וגוֹמֵר", שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְדַבֵּר מֵהַגָּלוּת, **However, regarding that which is written: "Now these are the names of the children of Israel, etc.", which does not speak of the exile directly,** הוּקְשָׁה לַמִּדְרָשׁ: דְּהָא כְּבָר הוּזְכְּרוּ שְׁמוֹתָן! **the Midrash was troubled: for their names had already been enumerated previously!** וְאָמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה א', ב'): "וְאֵלֶּה" – מוֹסִיף שֶׁבַח עַל הָרִאשׁוֹנִים וְכוּלֵי, **And it answered in Shemot Rabbah 1:2: "And these" adds praise upon the former ones, etc.; "** – וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת" הוֹסִיף שֶׁבַח עַל שִׁבְעִים נֶפֶשׁ שֶׁנֶּאֱמְרוּ לְמַעְלָה, שֶׁכֻּלָּם הָיוּ צַדִּיקִים. "[35] **And these are the names" added praise onto the seventy souls mentioned above, affirming that they were all righteous.**

וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין, מַה שַּׁיָּיךְ בָּזֶה "וְאֵלֶּה מוֹסִיף שֶׁבַח עַל הָרִאשׁוֹנִים", **And this requires comprehension: how does "and these adds praise upon the former" apply here,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהֵם הֵם הַשִּׁבְעִים נֶפֶשׁ הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְמַעְלָה בְּסֵפֶר בְּרֵאשִׁית, **since they are the very same seventy souls recorded above in the Book of Bereishit,** וּמַה מּוֹסִיף בָּזֶה? **and what additional praise is being introduced here?**

אָכֵן הָעִנְיָן הוּא, דְּכָאן כְּתִיב: "וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הַבָּאִים מִצְרַיְמָה אֵת יַעֲקֹב וְגוֹמֵר", **Indeed the explanation is: here it is written, "Now these are the names of the children of Israel who came into Egypt with Jacob, etc.",** וְלִכְאוֹרָה הָוָה לֵיהּ לְמֵימַר "בְּנֵי יַעֲקֹב", **and seemingly the verse ought to have said "the children of Jacob",** אוֹ לְכָתוֹב אַחַר כָּךְ "אֵת יִשְׂרָאֵל". **or written subsequently "with Israel" rather than "with Jacob".** אַךְ בָּזֶה לְהוֹסִיף שֶׁנִּשְׁלְמוּ בִּבְחִינַת "יִשְׂרָאֵל", שֶׁהוּא מַדְרֵגָה עֶלְיוֹנָה, **However, this comes specifically to add praise upon the former, that they attained perfection in the transcendent level of "Israel", which is an exalted spiritual degree,** וְנִקְרְאוּ כֻּלָּם "בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל". **and were all titled "the children of Israel".**

שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה שְׁלֵימוּת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁנִּשְׁלַם בְּמִצְרַיִם, **for this represented the ultimate fulfillment of our father Jacob, peace be upon him, which was perfected in Egypt,** וְאָמַר "אֵת יַעֲקֹב", כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "וַיְחִי יַעֲקֹב בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם", **as it is stated: "And Jacob lived in the land of Egypt",** שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה

[33] **Shemot Rabbah 1:2**: "Wherever "these" is said, it rejects what preceded; "and these" adds praise to what preceded. "These are the generations of heaven and earth" rejects chaos and emptiness. "And these are the names" adds praise to the seventy souls mentioned above, for all of them were righteous."

[34] **Bava Metzia 33b**: "Rabbi Yehudah son of Rabbi Ilai expounded: What does "Declare to My people their transgression, and to the house of Jacob their sins" mean? "Declare to My people their transgression" refers to Torah scholars, whose inadvertent sins are counted as deliberate ones. "To the house of Jacob their sins" refers to the unlearned, whose deliberate sins are counted as inadvertent ones. This accords with the Mishnah: Rabbi Yehudah says, "Take care in your learning, for an error in learning is counted as deliberate wrongdoing.""

[35] **Midrash Tanchuma, Shemot 3**: "All the tribes were named in reference to Israel's redemption. Reuben: 'I have indeed seen the affliction of My people.' Simeon: 'God heard their groaning.' Levi: 'Many nations shall join the Lord.' Judah: 'I thank You, Lord, though You were angry with me.' Issachar: 'There is a reward for your labor.' Zebulun: 'I have surely built You a dwelling house.' Benjamin: 'The Lord has sworn by His right hand.' Dan: 'The nation whom they serve, I shall judge.' Naphtali, read as nofet li, 'honey for me': 'Your lips drip honey, bride.' Gad: 'The manna was like coriander seed.' Asher: 'All the nations shall call you fortunate.' Joseph: 'The Lord shall once again extend His hand.'"

עִיקַּר חַיִּים שֶׁלּוֹ שֶׁנִּשְׁלַם שֶׁמִּטָּתוֹ שְׁלֵימָה. **for this was the essence of his true life, seeing it completed with his bed entirely pure.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאַף עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ מְכוּנִּים בְּשֵׁם יַעֲקֹב, **And this means that even the common folk are designated by the name of Jacob,** (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא לג עמוד ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ: **as expounded (Bava Metzia 33b): "**וּלְבֵית יַעֲקֹב חַטֹּאתָם" – אֵלּוּ עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ וְכוּ'לי,[36] **and to the house of Jacob their sins" – this refers to the common people, etc.,** דְּאַף שֶׁאֵין יוֹדְעִין כְּלָל עַד שֶׁזְּדוֹנוֹת נֶחְשָׁב לָהֶם לִשְׁגָגוֹת, **for even though they lack knowledge to such an extent that willful sins are considered errors for them,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם נִקְרָאִים "בֵּית יַעֲקֹב". **they are nonetheless titled "the house of Jacob".** וְזֶה שְׁלֵימוּת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁמִּטָּתוֹ שְׁלֵימָה. **And this constitutes the completeness of Jacob our father, peace be upon him, whose bed is whole.**

וְחָשַׁב כָּאן שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, **And the text enumerates here the names of the children of Israel,** (בַּמִּדְרָשׁ) וְאִיתָא עַל שֵׁם (ג'))) רַבָּה וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא רַבָּה וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא: **and it is taught (in Midrash Rabbah and Midrash Tanchuma, Shemot 3):** גְּאוּלַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל נִזְכְּרוּ כָּאן וְכוּ'לי,[37] **they are mentioned here alluding to the names of the redemption of Israel, etc.,** וְהַיְינוּ דְּכָאן מְדַבֵּר אַחַר שֶׁנִּשְׁלְמוּ שִׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא נְפָשׁוֹת, **which means that here the Torah speaks after the population attained the complete sum of 600,000 souls,** מִסְפַּר כָּל שׁוֹרֶשׁ כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **which is the total baseline root number of the Congregation of Israel,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ע"ט, א') וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: **and as written (Bereishit Rabbah 79:1):** לֹא נִפְטַר אָבִינוּ יַעֲקֹב מִן הָעוֹלָם עַד שֶׁרָאָה שִׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא מִבְּנֵי בָנָיו.[38] **Jacob our father did not depart this world until he beheld 600,000 descendants of his children's children.** וְאָז נִזְכְּרוּ הַשֵּׁמוֹת עַל שֵׁם גְּאוּלָּתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל, **And then the names were recorded alluding to the redemption of Israel,** וְזֶהוּ הַהֲכָנָה לְסֵפֶר שְׁמוֹת שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד "וַיְהִי אוֹר" שֶׁבּוֹ יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹרָה. **and this is the preparation for the Book of Shemot facing "And there was light" in which Israel emerged from darkness into radiant light.**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ מְסַיֵּם הַפָּרָשָׁה בְּמַאֲמַר מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: **And afterward the parashah concludes with the cry of Moses our teacher, peace be upon him: "**לָמָּה הֲרֵעוֹתָה לָעָם הַזֶּה", **"Wherefore have You dealt ill with this people,"** וּכְבָר הִקְשׁוּ הָרִאשׁוֹנִים זְכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה, **and early authorities of blessed memory already raised the difficulty,** שֶׁהֲרֵי כְּבָר הוֹדִיעַ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְמֹשֶׁה: "כִּי לֹא יִתֵּן אֹתָכֶם מֶלֶךְ מִצְרַיִם לַהֲלֹךְ וְגוֹמֵר", **for Hashem, blessed be He, had already notified Moses beforehand: "that the king of Egypt will not give you leave to go, etc.",** וְלָמָּה יִתְרַעֵם? **so why did he protest?**

וְנִרְאֶה עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה, שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה א', כ"ח): **And the explanation appears based on what is written (in Shemot Rabbah 1:28):** "וַיַּרְא בְּסִבְלֹתָם" – הָלַךְ מֹשֶׁה וְתִיקֵּן לָהֶם יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת לָנוּחַ.[39] **"And he looked on their burdens" – Moses went and instituted for them the Sabbath day to rest.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁתִּיקֵּן לָהֶם שֶׁיּוֹעִיל לָהֶם שְׁבִיתַת הַשַּׁבָּת **And this means he established for them that the resting on Shabbat should provide them spiritual fortitude** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה יוּכְלוּ לָצֵאת מֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹרָה.[40] **so that through it they would be able to break out from darkness into light.** שֶׁבְּמִצְרַיִם הָיוּ בְּתוֹךְ הַקְּלִיפָּה מוּקָף וּמוּסְגָּר מִכָּל צַד כְּעֶבֶד בְּבֶטֶן אִמּוֹ, **For in Egypt they were**

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[36] **Bereshit Rabbah 79:1**: "'You shall know that your offspring are many, and your descendants like the grass of the field.' Rabbi Yudan said: Our father Jacob did not depart this world until he had seen six hundred thousand of his descendants."

[37] **Shemot Rabbah 1:28**: "Another interpretation: "He saw their burdens." He saw that they had no rest. He went and told Pharaoh: If a person owns a slave and does not let him rest one day a week, the slave dies. These are your slaves; if you do not let them rest one day a week, they will die. He replied: Go and do for them as you say. Moses went and established Shabbat as their day of rest."

[38] **Shemot Rabbah 5:18**: ""Let the work weigh heavily upon the men." This teaches that they possessed scrolls in which they delighted from one Shabbat to the next, declaring that the Holy One, blessed be He, would redeem them, for they rested on Shabbat. Pharaoh told them, "Let the work weigh heavily upon the men, so that they work at it and pay no heed…" Let them neither delight in those scrolls nor rest on the Shabbat day."

[39] **Midrash Tehillim 119:26**: ""Had Your Torah not been my delight…" Israel said: Had Your Torah not been with me as my delight, I would have perished in my affliction. Moses likewise says, "When my anxious thoughts multiply within me…" Pharaoh likewise says, "Let the work weigh heavily upon the men…" They had books in which they delighted from one Shabbat to the next. Therefore it says, "Had Your Torah not been my delight…""

[40] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 10:83-11:92**: "Further, words of Torah become settled only there. There is no light except what emerges from darkness: when this side is subdued, God is exalted above and honored in His glory. Service of God comes only from darkness, and goodness only from evil. When a person enters an evil path and abandons it, God is exalted in His glory. Thus the perfection of everything is good and evil together, afterward rising through good. There is no good except what emerges from evil. Through this good His glory rises; this is complete service."

locked within the husk, enclosed and besieged from all directions like an embryo in the womb, וְתִיקֵן לָהֶם הַשַּׁבָּת שֶׁעַל יָדֵי כֵּן יוּכְלוּ לָצֵאת לְאוֹרָה. **and he instituted Shabbat so that through it they could emerge into great illumination.**

And subsequently it is stated (Shemot Rabbah 5:18): מִלַּמֵּד שֶׁהָיוּ בְיָדָם מְגִילּוֹת (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ה׳, י״ח) וְאַחַר כָּךְ אִיתָא: שֶׁהָיוּ מִשְׁתַּעְשְׁעִין בָּהֶן מִשַּׁבָּת לְשַׁבָּת לֵאמֹר שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גּוֹאֲלָן וְכוּ׳;[41] **this teaches that they possessed scrolls in which they delighted from Shabbat to Shabbat, declaring that the Holy One, blessed be He, would redeem them, etc.;** "אָמַר לָהֶם פַּרְעֹה: תִּכְבַּד הָעֲבֹדָה וְגוֹמֵר", **Pharaoh said to them: "Let the work be heavier, etc.",** אַל יְהוּ מִשְׁתַּעְשְׁעִין וְאַל יְהוּ נוֹפְשִׁין בְּיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת. **let them not delight and let them not rest on the Sabbath day.** "וְעַל זֶה צָעַק מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ אֶל ה': לָמָּה הֲרֵעוֹתָה וְגוֹמֵר", **And over this Moses our teacher cried out to Hashem: "Wherefore have You dealt ill, etc.",** שֶׁמָּא יִתְקַלְקְלוּ עוֹד **fearing lest, Heaven forbid, they deteriorate further spiritually** כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּתְבַּטֵּל מֵהֶם הַשַּׁבָּת וְהַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **once Shabbat and the words of Torah were stripped from them;** (שׁוֹחֵר טוֹב תְּהִלִּים קי״ט, ל״ב) עַל פָּסוּק "לוּלֵי תוֹרָתְךָ שַׁעֲשָׁעָי – **for so is the language in Midrash Shocher Tov (Psalm 119, section 32) on the verse "Unless Your Torah had been my delight"** – סְפָרִים הָיוּ לָהֶם וְהָיוּ מִשְׁתַּעְשְׁעִים בָּהֶם וְכוּ׳,[42] **scrolls they possessed and in them they took delight, etc.,** וּמִסְתָּמָא הָיָה לָהֶם הַפָּרָשִׁיוֹת שֶׁנֶּאֶמְרוּ בָּהֶם הַהַבְטָחוֹת שֶׁהִבְטִיחַ יִתְבָּרַךְ לָאָבוֹת שֶׁיִּגָּאֲלוּ **and presumably they held the scriptural portions recording the covenants and promises that Hashem guaranteed the Patriarchs that they would be redeemed,** וְזֶה הָיָה דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁלָּהֶם. **and this was their very Torah study.** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנִּתְבַּטְּלוּ מֵהֶם הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְהַשַּׁבָּת, **And once the Torah study and Shabbat were taken from them,** אָמַר מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ שֶׁהִרַּע לָעָם הַזֶּה שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְהִתְקַלְקֵל חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **Moses our teacher cried that it had worsened for this people, as they might collapse spiritually Heaven forbid,** וְאוֹהֲבוֹ שִׁחֲרוֹ מוּסָר "וְלֹא יִהְיֶה". **and it would cease to be "and he that loves him disciplines him early".**

And Hashem, blessed be He, demonstrated to him that this darkest hour was the darkness just before dawn, וְהָרְאָה לוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁזֶּה הוּא כְּעֵין קְדֵרוּתָא דְּצַפְרָא, מִזֶּה יִהְיֶה עִיקַּר הַהֲכָנָה לְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "וַיְהִי אוֹר" **and on the contrary, out of this would emerge the primary preparation for that which is proclaimed "And there was light",** שֶׁבּוֹ יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹר. **in which Israel emerged from darkness into great light.** וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד הַחֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁנִּזְכָּר בַּמַּאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן בְּרֵאשִׁית, **And this corresponds to the darkness mentioned in the first primordial utterance of Genesis,** שֶׁכָּךְ הָיָה סֵדֶר בְּרִיָּתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם: "בְּרֵישָׁא חֲשׁוֹכָא וַהֲדַר נְהוֹרָא", **for such was the blueprint of the creation of the world: "first darkness and then light",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב, קפד עמוד א): **and as written in the Zohar HaKadosh (Part II, 184a):** דְּלֵית נְהוֹרָא אֶלָּא מֵהוּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא וְכוּ׳.[43] **that there is no authentic light except that which emerges from out of the depths of darkness, etc.**

And this entire parashah is the preparation for the Book of Ve'eleh Shemot facing "And there was light" וְכָל הַפָּרָשָׁה זוֹ הֲכָנָה לְסֵפֶר וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד "וַיְהִי אוֹר" שֶׁבּוֹ יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹרָה. **in which Israel emerged**

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[41] **Zohar, Bereshit 78:196-79:206**: "Rabbi Shimon also said: we learned that Shabbat is an image of the world to come, and certainly it is. Thus the sabbatical year and Jubilee mirror one another, as do Shabbat and the world to come. The additional soul comes from the mystery of 'remember' to this Shelter of Peace, which receives it from the world to come and gives this addition to the holy people. They rejoice in that addition and forget every weekday matter, every sorrow and distress, as in 'On the day the Lord grants you rest from your pain, your turmoil and the hard labor,' and so forth."

[42] Parallel: **R. Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Tanya, Likkutei Amarim 26:5**: "The advised way to cleanse the heart of every sadness and trace of anxiety over worldly matters, even children, life, and livelihood, is the familiar teaching of our Sages, "Just as one blesses for the good…" The Gemara explains this as receiving it with joy, like the joy over a good that is openly seen. For "this too is for good," but it is not manifest to bodily eyes: it comes from the concealed world, higher than the revealed world. The revealed world corresponds to the vav and heh of the blessed Name Havayah, and the concealed world to yod and heh. Hence the verse, "Happy is the man whom You discipline, Yah," and so forth."
Connection: Tanya locates presently unseen goodness in a higher, concealed source, giving a complementary explanation of the inner rest Rav Tzadok describes while suffering remains unresolved.

[43] **Shemot Rabbah 1:4**: ""'Who came to Egypt"—are they arriving today? Had they not already been in Egypt for many days? Rather, while Joseph lived, they did not bear the Egyptians' burden. When Joseph died, they imposed the burden upon them. Therefore it says, "Who came," as though they entered Egypt that very day."
Context: The question appears in Shemot Rabbah 1:4 in Sefaria; the in-text reference reads 1:7.

from darkness into light. וְאַחַר כָּךְ מַתְחִיל הָעֲשָׂרָה פָּרָשִׁיוֹת מֵהַסֵּפֶר שֶׁהֵם כְּנֶגֶד עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת. **And subsequently begin the ten primary parashiyot of the book which align with the ten sefirot.**

"וְכֵן כְּתִיב: "בְּיוֹם הָנִיחַ ה' לְךָ וְגוֹמֵר וּמִן הָעֲבֹדָה הַקָּשָׁה וְגוֹמֵר, **And so it is written: "In the day that Hashem shall give you rest... and from the hard bondage, etc.",** שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א, מח עַמּוּד ב וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) עַל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא יוֹם הָנִיחַ, **which is expounded (Zohar I 48b and other sources) as referring to the Sabbath day which is the day of rest,** שֶׁאָז נוֹתֵן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ נִיחָא בְּלֵב הַיִּשְׂרְאֵלִי[44] [45]**for then Hashem, blessed be He, instills serenity and solace within the heart of the Jew** אַף כְּשֶׁהוּא בְּתוֹךְ הָעֲבוֹדָה הַקָּשָׁה **even while he finds himself trapped amidst crushing labor** וְנִרְאֶה שֶׁחַס וְשָׁלוֹם יִשְׂרָאֵל מִתְקַלְקְלִין עוֹד, **and it appears superficially as though Israel is further deteriorating, Heaven forbid;** אָז מַכִּיר הַיִּשְׂרְאֵלִי שֶׁהוּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **right then the Jew recognizes that this too is orchestrated from Hashem, blessed be He,** וְהוּא צוֹפֶה לְטוֹבָה **and he anticipates divine goodness** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵצְאוּ מֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹרָה **knowing that through this very tribulation they will break forth from darkness into light** "כִּימֵי צֵאתְךָ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם", **"as in the days of your coming out of the land of Egypt",** וְיִהְיֶה נָהוֹרָא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא, **and it will become the supreme light that bursts forth from within darkness,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵשׁ "וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִהְיֶה טוֹב מְאֹד", **and through this it will attain the status of "very good",** לְיִשְׂרָאֵל נִיחָא בַּלֵּב.[46] **and through this Israel possesses profound solace within the heart.**

וְהַמְשַׁמֵּר שַׁבָּת כְּהִלְכָתָהּ – נִגְאָל מִיָּד מִכָּל וָכֹל. **And whoever guards the Sabbath according to its halakhah is redeemed immediately from every form of bondage.**

שְׁמוֹת, מַאֲמָר ב׳ Shemos — Maamar Bais

"וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הַבָּאִים מִצְרַיְמָה אֵת יַעֲקֹב אִישׁ וּבֵיתוֹ בָּאוּ". **"Now these are the names of the children of Israel who came into Egypt with Jacob, every man and his household came."** פָּתַח "בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל", **Scripture begins with 'the children of Israel,'** וְאָמַר אַחַר כָּךְ "אֵת יַעֲקֹב". **and then states immediately afterward 'with**

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[44] **Shemot Rabbah 1:5**: ""These are the names of the children of Israel"—they are mentioned here in connection with Israel's redemption. Reuben: "I have surely seen My people's affliction." Simeon: "God heard their groaning." Levi: because the Holy One, blessed be He, joined in their distress, "from within the bush," fulfilling, "I am with him in distress." Judah: because they gave thanks to the Holy One, blessed be He. Issachar: the Holy One, blessed be He, rewarded their bondage with the spoil of Egypt and the sea, fulfilling, "Afterward they shall leave with great wealth." Zebulun: because the Holy One, blessed be He, caused His Presence to dwell among them, as it says, "They shall make Me a sanctuary, and I shall dwell among them." Zebulun signifies the Temple, as it says, "I have built You a lofty house, a place for You to dwell forever." Benjamin: "Your right hand, Lord, is majestic in strength." Dan: "The nation that enslaves them I shall judge, and afterward they shall leave with great wealth." Naphtali: the Torah and commandments the Holy One, blessed be He, gave them, of which it is written, "Sweeter than honey and dripping honeycomb." Gad: the manna the Holy One, blessed be He, fed them, which was "like coriander seed." Asher: all who heard of their redemption and greatness acclaimed them, as it is written, "All nations shall call you fortunate, for you shall be a land of delight, says the Lord of hosts." Joseph: because the Holy One, blessed be He, will again redeem Israel from the wicked kingdom, as He redeemed them from Egypt, as it is written, "On that day the Lord shall again extend His hand a second time…""

[45] **Tanna DeBei Eliyahu Rabbah 5**: "Why did Jacob merit life in this world without suffering and without the evil inclination, like what the Holy One, blessed be He, will give the righteous in the future? Because he sat in the house of study from youth to old age, proficient in Scripture, Mishnah, laws, and aggadot, as it says, "Jacob was a wholehearted man, dwelling in tents"; also, "Like arrows in a warrior's hand are the sons of youth; fortunate is the man…"; and, "To whom shall he teach knowledge?… Those weaned from milk, withdrawn from the breast." When he left his father's house for Laban's, the Divine Presence stood above him and answered: Jacob My son, raise your eyes to heaven. See the twelve constellations and the stars in the firmament, the twelve hours of day and twelve hours of night, corresponding to the twelve tribes I give you. When Jacob returned from Laban's house and Joseph was sold, he wept and mourned twenty-two years, as it says, "All his sons and daughters arose to comfort him… His father wept for him." Was he weeping only for Joseph? Rather, he said: Perhaps I incurred guilt by marrying two sisters, or by benefiting from Laban's or Shechem's wealth, and the covenant the Holy One, blessed be He, made with me has been annulled. Immediately the mercy of the Holy One, blessed be He, was stirred, and He gave Jacob seventeen good years near his old age, resembling the world to come."

[46] **Bava Metzia 33b**: "Rabbi Yehudah son of Rabbi Ilai expounded: What does "Declare to My people their transgression, and to the house of Jacob their sins" mean? "Declare to My people their transgression" refers to Torah scholars, whose inadvertent sins are counted as deliberate ones. "To the house of Jacob their sins" refers to the unlearned, whose deliberate sins are counted as inadvertent ones. This accords with the Mishnah: Rabbi Yehudah says, "Take care in your learning, for an error in learning is counted as deliberate wrongdoing.""

Jacob.' וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ דִּקְדֵּק: **And in the holy Zohar it meticulously notes:** כֵּיוָן דִּכְתִיב "בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל", מַהוּ "אֵת הַבָּאִים אִתּוֹ" אִצְטְרִיךְ "עִם יַעֲקֹב"? **since it is written 'the children of Israel,' what is the meaning of 'with Jacob'? "** וְהַמְכַוֵּון גַּם כֵּן דְּעַל כָּל פָּנִים הָוֶה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר "אֵת לְמֵימַר. **It should rather have simply said: 'who came with him.'** יִשְׂרָאֵל". **And the intent of the difficulty is likewise that at the very least it should have stated 'with Israel.'** "הַבָּאִים שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר גַּם יֵשׁ לְהָבִין מַה", **Moreover, it is necessary to understand why it is phrased 'who are coming' (habba'im, in the present tense),** שֶׁהָרֵי כְּבָר בָּאוּ, **when they had already arrived previously,** וַהֲוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר "אֲשֶׁר בָּאוּ", **and it should rather have stated 'who had come' (asher ba'u);** וְכֵן הִקְשָׁה בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה א׳, ז׳): **and so Shemot Rabbah 1:7 raised the difficulty:** וְכִי הַיּוֹם בָּאִים? **Do they arrive today?** וַהֲלֹא יָמִים רַבִּים הָיָה לָהֶם שֶׁבָּאוּ לְמִצְרַיִם וְכוּ׳.[47] **Behold, many years had already passed since they came down to Egypt, etc.!**

אָכֵן כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ: **Indeed, we have already explained this based on what is taught in the Midrash: "**הוֹסִיף שְׁבָח עַל שִׁבְעִים נֶפֶשׁ שֶׁנֶּאֶמְרוּ לְמַעְלָה שֶׁכֻּלָּם הָיוּ צַדִּיקִים – וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת. **'And these are the names' added praise upon the seventy souls mentioned above, affirming that they were all righteous.** וְלִכְאוֹרָה כֵּיוָן שֶׁהֵן הֵמָּה "לֹא שַׁיָּיךְ בָּזֶה "הוֹסִיף שְׁבָח", **And ostensibly, 'adding praise' does not appear applicable here,** שִׁבְעִים נֶפֶשׁ שֶׁנִּזְכְּרוּ בְּפָרָשַׁת וַיִּגַּשׁ. **since they are the very same seventy souls enumerated in Parashat Vayigash.** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהוֹסִיף שְׁבָח בַּמָּה שֶׁזָּכוּ לִהְיוֹת שְׁמוֹתֵיהֶן נִזְכָּר עַל שֵׁם גְּאוּלַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **And we explained that it added praise in that they merited having their personal names recorded as an omen alluding to the redemption of Israel,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה א׳, ה׳): **as it is written in Shemot Rabbah 1:5:** רְאוּבֵן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "רָאֹה רָאִיתִי אֶת עֳנִי עַמִּי", וְכֵן כֻּלָּם.[48] – **Reuven corresponds to 'I have surely seen (ra'oh ra'iti) the affliction of My people,' and similarly all of them.** וַיְהִי שֶׁבְּפָרָשַׁת וַיִּגַּשׁ מְדַבֵּר מִבְּיאַת הַשְּׁבָטִים עִם הַשִּׁבְעִים נֶפֶשׁ, **Namely, in Parashat Vayigash Scripture speaks of the physical arrival of the tribes alongside the seventy souls;** וְכָאן מְדַבֵּר מִשְּׁמוֹת הַשְּׁבָטִים שֶׁמְּרַמְּזִין עַל גְּאוּלָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל, **whereas here it speaks of the essential names of the tribes which allude to the spiritual redemption of Israel,** שֶׁכָּאן מַתְחִיל סִיפּוּר הַגָּלוּת. **because here begins the explicit chronicle of the exile.**

וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "הַבָּאִים" בְּלָשׁוֹן הֹוֶה, **And it can be said that this accounts for the phrase 'who are coming' (habba'im) in the present tense:** דִּכְשֶׁנִּכְתַּב הַגָּלוּת, **for at the very moment the exile was inscribed,** אָז הוֹפִיעַ הָאוֹר מִשְּׁמוֹת הַשְּׁבָטִים שֶׁרוֹמְזִין לִגְאוּלַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **right then the transcendent light shone forth from the names of the tribes which hint toward Israel's redemption.** וְעַל כֵּן הִזְכִּירָן בְּשֵׁם "בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל" עַל שֵׁם מַעֲלָתָן, **Therefore Scripture initially designates them by the title 'the children of Israel' after their lofty stature,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה "כִּי שָׂרִיתָ עִם אֱלֹהִים וְעִם אֲנָשִׁים". **which signifies 'for you have striven with God and with men and have prevailed.'** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּתִיב "אֶת יַעֲקֹב", **And afterward it is written 'with Jacob,'** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּסוֹף וַיִּגַּשׁ "וַיֵּשֶׁב יִשְׂרָאֵל וְגוֹמֵר", **just as we explained regarding what is stated at the conclusion of Vayigash, 'And Israel dwelt, etc.,'** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאָז נִשְׁלַם יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בְּאֶרֶץ גֹּשֶׁן, **which means that then our father Jacob, peace be upon him, attained complete spiritual wholeness in the land of Goshen,** וְחַי חַיִּים שֶׁלֹּא בְּצַעַר וְשֶׁלֹּא בְּיֵצֶר הָרָע (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סֵדֶר אֵלִיָּהוּ רַבָּה פֶּרֶק ה).[49] **and lived a life devoid of sorrow and untouched by the evil inclination (as written in Seder Eliyahu Rabbah, chapter 5).** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּתִיב "וַיִּחַי

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[47] **Midrash Tanchuma, Shemot 4**: "The name Yaakov has four letters, corresponding to four crowns with which his children crown the Holy One, blessed be He: yod corresponds to the Ten Commandments; ayin, to the seventy elders; qof, to the Temple his children built for Him, whose height was one hundred cubits, as it says, 'The Temple: one hundred cubits'; and bet, to the two tablets."

[48] **Zohar, Bereshit 21:238-248**: "As soon as he comes, 'A mist shall rise from the earth': the alef-dalet of Adonai raises vav to him, becoming within her 'Lord of all the earth.' Immediately, 'It waters the whole face of the ground.' From him Israel below is watered through the seventy facets of Torah."

[49] **Bava Metzia 59b**: "Rabbi Eliezer again told them: "If the law follows my view, let Heaven prove it." A heavenly voice declared: "Why do you contend with Rabbi Eliezer, when the law follows him everywhere?" Rabbi Yehoshua rose to his feet and declared: "It is not in heaven!" What does "It is not in heaven" mean? Rabbi Yirmiyah said: The Torah has already been given at Mount Sinai. We pay no attention to a heavenly voice, for You already wrote in the Torah at Mount Sinai, "Follow the majority." Rabbi Natan met Elijah and asked him: "What was the Holy One, blessed be He, doing at that moment?" He answered: "He was smiling and saying, 'My children have prevailed over Me! My children have prevailed over Me!'""

יַעֲקֹב וְגוֹמֵר", **And subsequently it is written 'And Jacob lived, etc.,'** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז שֶׁהִכְנִיס הַחַיִּים וְהַשְׁלֵימוּת בְּכָל זַרְעוֹ, **which hints that he infused enduring vitality and perfection throughout all of his offspring,** דְּאַף עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ יֵשׁ לָהֶם קְבִיעוּת בִּקְדוּשָּׁה וְנִקְרְאוּ "בֵּית יַעֲקֹב",[50] **such that even the common folk possess an enduring fixture in holiness and are titled 'the house of Jacob,'** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא לג עמוד ב),[51] **and as written in Bava Metzia (33b),** וְעַל כֵּן נִזְכָּר בְּשֵׁם יַעֲקֹב. **and therefore he is recalled specifically by the name 'Jacob.'** וְכֵן מוֹרֶה שֶׁזֶּה הָאוֹר שֶׁיִּרְמֹז עַל גְּאוּלַת יִשְׂרָאֵל, זְכֵה לָהֶם יַעֲקֹב", **And likewise does 'with Jacob' signify here:** כָּאן "אֶת יַעֲקֹב **that this illumination alluding to Israel's redemption was merited unto them through Jacob,** שֶׁהוּא הַשְׁלֵימוּת מִצִּדּוֹ לְהָאִיר לְכָל זַרְעוֹ. **representing the foundational perfection from his side designed to radiate unto all of his descendants.**

((ד׳) וְאִיתָא (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא לְפָרָשָׁה זוֹ: **And it is brought (in Midrash Tanchuma, Shemot 4):** יַעֲקֹב אַרְבַּע אוֹתִיּוֹת יֵשׁ בּוֹ **The name Ya'akov contains four letters** כְּנֶגֶד אַרְבַּע עֲטָרוֹת שֶׁבָּנָיו מְעַטְּרִין לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא:[52] **corresponding to four crowns with which his children crown the Holy One, blessed be He:** יו"ד – כְּנֶגֶד עֲשֶׂרֶת הַדִּבְּרוֹת, **Yod corresponds to the Ten Commandments;** עי"ן – כְּנֶגֶד שִׁבְעִים זְקֵנִים, **Ayin corresponds to the seventy elders;** קו"ף – כְּנֶגֶד הַהֵיכָל שֶׁגָּבְהוֹ מֵאָה אַמָּה, **Kuf corresponds to the Sanctuary whose height was one hundred cubits;** בֵּי"ת – כְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵי הַלּוּחוֹת וְכוּלֵי. **Beit corresponds to the two Tablets of Stone, etc.** הַתְּחָלַת וְסִיּוּם שְׁמוֹ מוֹרֶה עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב: **The opening and closing letters of his name (Yod and Beit) indicate the Written Torah:** עֲשֶׂרֶת הַדִּבְּרוֹת וּשְׁנֵי לוּחוֹת. **the Ten Commandments and the two Tablets.** וּבָאֶמְצַע, עי"ן – כְּנֶגֶד שִׁבְעִים זְקֵנִים, **And in the center, the letter Ayin corresponds to the seventy elders,** וְהֵיכָנוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה שִׁבְעִים דְּעוֹת, **meaning that there exist within the words of Torah seventy facets and approaches,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א, כו: עמוד א וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) וּבַתִּיקוּנִים: **and as written in the holy Zohar (Part I, 26a and elsewhere) and in the Tikkunim:** שִׁבְעִין אַנְפִּין לְאוֹרַיְיתָא.[53] **seventy faces to the Torah.** וְנֶגֶד זֶה שִׁבְעִים זְקֵנִים וְסַנְהֶדְרִין. **And facing this stand the seventy elders and the Great Sanhedrin.** וְכֵן הַקו"ף שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְגוֹבַהּ הַהֵיכָל, **And likewise the letter Kuf which alludes to the height of the Sanctuary,** שָׁם הַמְּנוֹרָה **where the golden Menorah was situated,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז גַּם כֵּן עַל אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **which also hints toward the luminous light of the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים (תְּצַוֶּה וּבְהַעֲלֹתְךָ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּמָה שֶׁהוּא מְכֻוָּן): **just as we have mentioned many times that this is the intent of what is stated in Midrash Rabbah (Tetzaveh and Beha'alotekha): "**בּוֹאוּ וְהָאִירוּ לִי", **'Come and cast light for Me,'** שֶׁהוּא מְרַמֵּז עַל בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **which alludes to the dimension of the Oral Torah** שֶׁהָאוֹר מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל, **wherein the spiritual illumination emanates from the side of the Jewish people,** כְּמוֹ

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[50] **Bereshit Rabbah 81**: "'But I shall tell you what is inscribed in the writing of truth.' If it is true, why call it merely 'inscribed'? And if it is merely inscribed, why call it 'true'? Rabbi Yehudah HaNasi asked, 'Did you not know how to answer?' Rabbi Levi replied: 'It is inscribed before the decree is issued; it is true once the decree has been issued.' What is truth? The seal of the Holy One, blessed be He. Our Master said in Rabbi Reuven's name: It is emet, 'truth.' What is emet? Reish Lakish said: Alef stands at the beginning of the alphabet, mem in the middle, and tav at the end, corresponding to 'I am the first, and I am the last.'"

[51] **Zohar, Beshalach 25:337-26:348**: "Rabbi Eleazar said: they went out into the wilderness to gaze, but God removed the radiance of His glory from there. They went to gaze upon Him and did not find Him. We have learned that God is called Torah: water means Torah, and Torah means the Holy One, blessed be He."

[52] **Berakhot 21a**: "Rav Yehudah said: Where does the Torah require the blessing after a meal? "You shall eat, be satisfied, and bless." Where does the Torah require a blessing before Torah study? "When I proclaim Hashem's name, ascribe greatness to our God.""

[53] **Vayikra Rabbah 9**: "Rabbi Yannai was walking along the road and saw a man who appeared very distinguished. He said: Will the master consent to be our guest? He replied: Yes. He brought him home, fed him, and gave him drink. He tested him in Scripture and found him unlearned; in Mishnah, aggadah, and Talmud, and found him unlearned. He said: Take the cup and recite the blessing. The man replied: Let Yannai bless in his own house. He asked: Can you repeat what I tell you? He replied: Yes. He told him to say: A dog has eaten Yannai's bread. The man rose, seized him, and said: My inheritance is with you, and you withhold it from me! He asked: What inheritance of yours is with me? He replied: Once I passed a school and heard the children saying, "Moses commanded us Torah, an inheritance of the congregation of Jacob." It does not say "the congregation of Yannai," but "the congregation of Jacob." He asked: Through what merit did you eat at my table? He replied: Never have I heard an evil report and carried it back to its subject; never have I seen two people quarrelling without making peace between them. Yannai said: You possess all this proper conduct, yet I called you a dog! He applied to him, "One who orders his way": one who evaluates his path is worth much. For Rabbi Yishmael bar Rav Nachman said: Proper conduct preceded Torah by twenty-six generations, as it is written, "To guard the way of the tree of life." "The way" is proper conduct, and afterward, "the tree of life" is Torah."

(ב בָּבָא מְצִיעָא נט עַמּוּד ב) שֶׁכָּתוּב: **as written in Bava Metzia (59b): "**לֹא בַשָּׁמַיִם הִיא וְכוּ', נִצְּחוּנִי בָנַי"[54] **It is not in heaven, etc., My children have triumphed over Me' (**וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה**). (and this was explained regarding Chanukah).**

וְהָעִנְיָן, שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שִׁמְשׁוֹ שֶׁמֶשׁ, **And the deeper meaning is that our father Jacob, peace be upon him, his luminary is the Sun,** שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְשֵׁם הַוָ"ה. **for he serves as the Chariot for the holy Tetragrammaton.** וּכְתִיב: "תִּתֵּן אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב", **And Scripture states: 'You will grant truth to Jacob,' "** – אֱמֶת" **where Emet (Truth) spans Alef at the beginning of the alphabet, Tav at the end, and Mem in the exact center (**אָלֶ"ף בְּרֵאשִׁית וְתָ"ו בְּסוֹפָן, מֵ"ם בְּאֶמְצָעִיתָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פא), (55**as written in Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 81),** וְזֶה מוֹרֶה שֵׁם הַוָ"ה: הָיָה, הֹוֶה, וְיִהְיֶה. **and this directly denotes the Tetragrammaton: He was, He is, and He shall ever be.** וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא תּוֹרָה אִיקָרֵי **And the Holy One, blessed be He, is Himself called Torah,** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב, ס עַמּוּד א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב, **as written in the Zohar (Part II, 60a),** (בִּבְרָכוֹת כא עַמּוּד א) וְכֵן נִדְרַשׁ:[56] **and likewise it is expounded in Berakhot (21a): "**כִּי שֵׁם ה' אֶקְרָא, הָבוּ גֹדֶל לֵאלֹקֵינוּ – **on the verse 'When I proclaim the Name of Hashem, ascribe greatness, etc.' –** לְבִרְכַּת הַתּוֹרָה וְגוֹמֵר" **as the biblical source for the blessing recited prior to Torah study,**[57] שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה נִקְרֵאת שֵׁם הַוָ"ה, **demonstrating that the Torah is titled by the Name of the Tetragrammaton,** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (שָׁם ה עַמּוּד ב): "אֱמֶת **And after this name he is titled 'Israel,'** וְעַל שֵׁם זֶה נִקְרָא "יִשְׂרָאֵל", דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וְאוֹרַיְיתָא וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא חַד כַּיָּדוּעַ. **for Israel, the Torah, and the Holy One, blessed be He, are completely one, as is known.**

וּבֶאֱמֶת כְּלוּל בְּהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב כָּל אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה גַּם כֵּן, **And in truth, within the Written Torah is enveloped all the radiance of the Oral Torah as well,** וְעַל זֶה מְרֻמָּז הַפְּנִימִיּוּת מִשֵּׁם יַעֲקֹב: עַי"ן קו"ף **and toward this alludes the inner core of the name Ya'akov: the central letters Ayin and Kuf,** שֶׁרוֹמְזִים לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, **which hint at the light of the Oral Torah as we have explained,** וְאוֹתִיּוֹת יו"ד בֵּי"ת רוֹמְזִים לַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **while the outer letters Yod and Beit point to the Written Torah.** וְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לוֹ חֵלֶק בַּתּוֹרָה

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[54] Parallel: **Pri Tzaddik, Shoftim 11:1**: "Afterward He says, "I have placed My words in your mouth." Every Jew is capable of becoming one of those who labor in Torah. If Hashem delights in him and he thirsts for words of Torah, Hashem is ready to place Torah within him. "I have placed My words in your mouth"—then you yourself become one who "plants the heavens and establishes the earth's foundation," as the Zohar says: the Holy One rejoices with him as though He had planted heaven and earth that very day. Every Jew is capable of this. The Midrash says: "All wisdom and all Torah are one simple matter: whoever fears Me and practices Torah will have all wisdom and Torah in his heart." Every Jew has a portion in Torah, as it says, "The inheritance of Jacob's congregation." The Midrash therefore says, "My inheritance is with you"—it does not say "the congregation of Yannai," but "the congregation of Jacob." Even the unlearned are called Jacob. Every Jew truly has a portion in Torah and can attain the standing of those who labor in it."

Connection: Shoftim develops the practical implication of the unlearned guest's claim: inherited Torah is a capacity to receive and labor in Torah, not merely a claim to respectful treatment.

[55] **Zohar, Shemot 5:33-7:43**: "'These are the names of the children of Israel.' Rabbi Eleazar and Rabbi Yose were traveling. Rabbi Eleazar said: 'Open your mouth, and let your words shine.' Rabbi Yose replied: 'May I ask something difficult? I heard the Holy Lamp explain "the children of Israel" as Israel the Elder: all the hosts and camps descending into exile with Jacob, as it says, "with Jacob." What then is "each man and his household came"?' He answered: 'Certainly so. We learned that whoever receives from another is that giver's house. Hence "each man and his household came."'"

[56] **Bereshit Rabbah 16**: "Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chalafta said: All the kingdoms are called by the name 'Egypt,' because they bring distress upon Israel."

[57] **Shemot Rabbah 46:1**: "He began grieving over the breaking of the tablets. The Holy One, blessed be He, told him: Do not grieve over the first tablets, which contained only the Ten Commandments. In the second tablets I give you, there will be laws, midrash, and aggadot, as it is written, "He will tell you wisdom's hidden things, for sound wisdom is doubled." Moreover, you receive the tidings that I have forgiven your sin, as it says, "Know that God remits some of your iniquity.""

Shemot Rabbah 47:7: "The Holy One, blessed be He, said: You suffered; by your life, you will not lose! The first tablets contained only the Ten Commandments. Now that you have suffered, I give you laws, midrashim, and aggadot, as it says, "Write for yourself these words." Why did the Holy One, blessed be He, say "Write for yourself," when it is written, "The writing was God's writing, engraved upon the tablets," and, "He wrote upon the tablets like the first writing"? Rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, told him: Write Torah, Prophets, and Writings, so that they shall be written; but laws, midrash, aggadot, and the Talmud shall remain oral. When Moses understood, he began saying, "It is good for me that I was afflicted"; "The Torah of Your mouth is good for me.""

שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **And every single individual among Israel possesses a personal share in the Oral Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ט): **as it is written in Vayikra Rabbah (Parashah 9): "**יְרוּשָּׁתִי גַּבָּךְ וְכוּלֵי, **'My inheritance is with you, etc.,' '**מוֹרָשָׁה קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב' וְכוּלֵי, "[58]**it is not written here: an inheritance of the congregation of Yannai, but rather the congregation of Jacob, etc.,'** וַהֲיֵינוּ אַף עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ "בֵּית יַעֲקֹב", יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק בַּתּוֹרָה. **meaning that even the common folk who are designated 'the house of Jacob' retain an organic portion in the Torah.** וַהֲרֵי זֶה הָאוֹרֵחַ שֶׁהָיָה עִם הָאָרֶץ **And behold, even that humble guest who was an unlettered commoner,** עַד שֶׁהָיָה סָבוּר רַבִּי יַנַּאי שֶׁאֵינוֹ בְּדֶרֶךְ אֶרֶץ גַּם כֵּן **such that Rabbi Yannai initially suspected that he was devoid even of basic derekh eretz (civil courtesy),** וְלֹא יָדַע כְּלָל בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **possessing no knowledge of Torah words whatever** רַק פָּסוּק זֶה שֶׁשָּׁמַע מֵהַתִּינוֹקוֹת – **save this single verse which he had overheard from school children –** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיָה לוֹ חֵלֶק בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **nonetheless possessed an authentic portion in the Oral Torah,** שֶׁחִדֵּשׁ זֹאת: **in that he innovated this very insight:** שֶׁאַף עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק וְיִרֻשָּׁה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה.[59] **that even unlettered folk retain an inherent share and legacy in the words of Torah.**

וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵת יַעֲקֹב אִישׁ וּבֵיתוֹ בָּאוּ", **And this is what Scripture states: 'with Jacob, every man and his household came,'** וְעַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב, ד עַמּוּד א): **and along the lines of what is written in the holy Zohar (Part II, 4a): "**כָּל דִּמְקַבֵּל מֵאַחֲרָא אִיהוּ בֵּיתָא מֵהַהוּא דְיָהִיב וְכוּלֵי, "[60]**Whoever receives from another is considered the household/vessel of that one who bestows, etc.,'** וְכֵן בְּכָל הַמִּדּוֹת הַמְקַבֵּל נִקְרָא בְּחִינַת בַּיִת. **and so across all spiritual attributes the recipient is titled the aspect of 'House' (bayit).** וַיַּעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה מֶרְכָּבָה לְשֵׁם הָוָי"ה שֶׁנִּקְרָא שָׁמֶשׁ, **And our father Jacob, peace be upon him, was the Chariot for the Tetragrammaton which is termed the Sun,** וְאַנְהִיר לְסִיהֲרָא בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל: מַלְכוּת, פֶּה, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **and he radiates light unto the Moon, which is the aspect of the Congregation of Israel: Malchut, the Mouth, the Oral Torah.**

וְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה הֵם נְצָחִיִּים, שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֶמְרוּ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם רַק לְשָׁעָתָם. **And the words of Torah are eternal, having never been stated merely for their immediate historical moment, Heaven forbid.** וּכְתִיב "הַבָּאִים מִצְרַיְמָה" בִּלְשׁוֹן הֹוֶה, **And Scripture writes 'who are coming into Egypt' in the present tense,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל כָּל הַגָּלֻיּוֹת, **which alludes to all historical exiles,** שֶׁכֻּלָּם נִקְרְאוּ עַל שֵׁם שֶׁהֵם מְצִירוֹת לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, עַל שֵׁם מִצְרַיִם, **all of which are named after Egypt (Mitzrayim) because they cause distress (meitzir) unto Israel,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה טז).[61] **as written in Bereishit Rabbah (Parashah 16).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל", **And this explains the verse: 'Now these are the names of the children of Israel,'** שֶׁמְּרַמְּזִין עַל שֵׁם גְּאוּלָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל; **which allude directly to the redemption of Israel; "**הַבָּאִים מִצְרַיְמָה" – שֶׁבְּכָל הַגָּלֻיּוֹת שֶׁבָּאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל,[62] **and 'who are**

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[58] **Ecclesiastes 1:18**: "For abundant wisdom brings abundant vexation, and whoever increases knowledge increases pain."

[59] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 10:83-11:92**: "Further, words of Torah become settled only there. There is no light except what emerges from darkness: when this side is subdued, God is exalted above and honored in His glory. Service of God comes only from darkness, and goodness only from evil. When a person enters an evil path and abandons it, God is exalted in His glory. Thus the perfection of everything is good and evil together, afterward rising through good. There is no good except what emerges from evil. Through this good His glory rises; this is complete service."

[60] Parallel: **Pri Tzaddik, Chayei Sara 6:1**: "The wisdom of all the people of the East was a place where the Oral Torah was in exile. Their wisdom stood on the opposing side of the Oral Torah. The holy Zohar explains that in those eastern mountains people taught others sorcery; Laban, Beor, and his son Balaam came from that eastern land. Balaam embodied knowledge on the side of impurity. Scripture says of Solomon's wisdom—the lower wisdom, the Oral Torah—that it "surpassed" the wisdom of all the people of the East and all Egypt's wisdom: it grew through the holy sparks he extracted from those forms of wisdom. Although Egypt's wisdom opposed the Written Torah, Scripture includes Egypt here because the Oral Torah has its root in the Written Torah."

Connection: Chayei Sara identifies a concrete model of this extraction: Solomon's Torah wisdom grows through the holy life reclaimed from Egyptian and eastern wisdom.

[61] **Zohar, Bereshit 75:178-77:188**: "'God completed on the seventh day': this is the Oral Torah, which is the seventh day. Through it the world was perfected, for it sustains everything. 'His work which He had made,' rather than 'all His work,' for the Written Torah brought everything forth through the power of the writing that proceeds from Wisdom."

[62] **Shemot Rabbah 1:28**: "Another interpretation: "He saw their burdens." He saw that they had no rest. He went and told Pharaoh: If a person owns a slave and does not let him rest one day a week, the slave dies. These are your slaves;